

A Framework for Advanced Signature Notions

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Abstract. The beyond unforgeability features formalize additional security properties for signature schemes. We develop a general framework of binding properties for signature schemes that encompasses existing beyond unforgeability features and reveals new notions. Furthermore, we give new results regarding various transforms: We show that the transform by Cremers et al. (SP’21) achieves all of our security notions; we give a modified definition of so-called weak keys, and show that the Pornin–Stern transform (ACNS’05) also achieves all notions if there are no weak keys. Finally, we connect our framework to unforgeability notions.

1 Introduction

Signature schemes, key-encapsulation mechanisms, and authenticated encryption are among the most basic cryptographic primitives, achieving fundamental security goals such as confidentiality, integrity, and authenticity. These security goals are attained by showing constructions to achieve standard security notions, such as *existential unforgeability under chosen message attack* (EUF-CMA) in case of signature schemes. In practice, though, the aforementioned primitives are seldom used as standalone primitives. They are commonly embedded into larger, more complex protocols. The way a protocol makes use of a primitive can open new attack vectors that are beyond what standard security, like, say, EUF-CMA security, guarantees. The recent literature provides numerous examples for such attacks with severe effects: the “Facebook message franking attack” [DGRW18], the “partitioning oracle attack” [LGR21], the “subscribe with Google attack” [ADG⁺22], the “Let’s Encrypt attack” [Aye15], the “Dynamically Recreatable Key attack” [JCCS19], and the “PQXDH re-encapsulation attack” [BJKS24]. The list certainly does not end here as more attacks, against other existing or future protocols are sure to be found. All of these attacks were possible *even* for cryptographic primitives that were proven secure in the standard sense, e.g., EUF-CMA security.

To deal with the problem, new security notions for authenticated encryption, key-encapsulation mechanisms, and signature schemes were developed, with the

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goal of preventing attacks like those in the aforementioned list. For authenticated encryption and key-encapsulation, so-called committing and binding security, respectively, prevent attacks like the ones described above. For signature schemes, the so-called *beyond unforgeability features* or *BUFF security notions* were introduced for this purpose [CDF⁺21]. As of now, there are six BUFF security notions: Strong conservative exclusive ownership (S-CEO), strong destructive exclusive ownership (S-DEO), strong universal exclusive ownership (S-UEO), malicious strong universal exclusive ownership (M-S-UEO), message-bound signatures (MBS), and non-resignability (NR). The first four are variants of *exclusive ownership* notions, which, roughly speaking, ask if one can find a public key that verifies a signature from a different public key—the different variants cover various subtleties of this core idea.

Absence of exclusive ownership, can lead to severe consequences as illustrated by the attack against the Let’s Encrypt protocol [Aye15].³ The idea behind the protocol was that Alice (who wants a certificate for a domain she owns) receives a challenge message from Let’s Encrypt and is supposed to update the DNS record to contain a signature of the challenge message. Let’s Encrypt can then verify the signature from the DNS record with the target message and convince itself that Alice indeed owns the domain. In the attack [Aye15], Eve would try to register Alice’s domain as its own: It initiates the protocol with Let’s Encrypt and receives another challenge message. Assume Eve can find a public key that verifies this new challenge message and Alice’s *existing* signature—thereby $\mathcal{A}$ circumvents the problem that it cannot manipulate the DNS record of Alice’s website. Then Eve can update the public key used by Let’s Encrypt such that the verification check at the end of the protocol will succeed and Eve will receive a certificate despite not owning the domain.⁴ Having signatures that provide exclusive ownership prevents adversaries to find such public keys in the first place, thereby ruling out the attack. The notion MBS is related to the non-repudiation property of signatures: it asks to find a public key and *one* signature that verifies *two distinct* messages. The notion NR asks an adversary to morph a signature of an *unknown* message for one public key, into a signature for the same message but a different public key.

As mentioned earlier, there are no guarantees that the existing list of attacks is complete—in fact, it seems even likely that more attacks will be found in the future. Ideally, we would like to design and analyze cryptographic primitives today, such that they withstand not just the known attacks but also the currently unknown attacks. To achieve that, we need security notions that cover all different attack vectors that might be exploited in such (potentially still

³ Note that the proposed protocol was not implemented at the time and could be fixed before being used.

⁴ The core vulnerability was that Eve can initiate the protocol with Let’s Encrypt using one public key but end it with a different one. The protocol was fixed by excluding executions ending with different public keys than they started with.

unknown) attacks.⁵ For authenticated encryption and key-encapsulation mechanisms, we do have these security notions: Menda et al. [MLGR23] developed a complete framework of security notions for committing security while Cremers et al. [CDM24] did the same for key-encapsulation mechanisms. For signature schemes, on the other hand, there is no formal framework covering the various subtleties that might go wrong. While the BUFF security notions already catch a number of these cases, the following question remains open:

Are the BUFF security notions complete?

1.1 Contribution

In this work, we address the aforementioned question. We apply the blueprint of binding properties (as done in [CDM24] for key-encapsulation mechanisms) to signature schemes.

The generic structure of each notion is AM-B-T, which can be read as “B binds T in attack model AM”. Here, B and T are subsets of {S, M, P}, which represent the signature, message, and public key, respectively, while $AM \in \{\text{MAL}, \text{LEAK}, \text{HON}\}$ represents one of three attack models. By this, we obtain a total of 36 security notions. Removing notions that are not meaningful, leaves us with 15 security notions—5 notion classes (on which we elaborate below) each of which can be considered in the 3 different attack models (MAL, LEAK, and HON), which differ in how the keys are generated. Our 5 notion classes can be distinguished as follows. There are 2 *generalized notions*: AM-S-M (does a signature bind a message?) and AM-S-P (does a signature bind a public key?). There are 3 *restricted notions*: AM-[S,M]-P (do signature and message *together* bind a public key?), AM-S-[M,P] (does a signature bind *the pair* of message and public key?), and AM-[S,P]-M (do signature and public key *together* bind a message?). These notions cover the existing BUFF security notions S-CEO, S-DEO, S-UEO, M-S-UEO, and MBS. The notions S-CEO, S-DEO, and MBS correspond to the restricted notion AM-[S,M]-P, AM-S-[M,P], and AM-[S,P]-M, respectively; an interesting observation here, is that MBS is in a different attack model (MAL) than S-CEO and S-DEO (which are HON). The notions S-UEO and M-S-UEO belong to the notion class AM-S-P, differing only in their attack model (HON and MAL). The remaining BUFF notion of non-resignability cannot be captured by the proposed formalism due to the concept of a message that is concealed from the adversary. We introduce hiding of components as an additional feature and denote it by overlining the corresponding letter, e.g., $\overline{M}$ for the message being hidden. This allows us to model a weaker form of non-resignability (wNR) as the notion HON- $\widehat{M}$ -P. This weaker form wNR differs from NR in two aspects: (1) the message is chosen uniformly and (2) the adversary does not receive any auxiliary information about it. It was first introduced in [ADM⁺24]—and afterwards considered in [Emu24, KX24]—due to the fact that the original formulation

⁵ This means of course only security in a black-box sense, where the adversary has no access to the internal workings—unlike, say, side-channel attacks.

of NR was proven faulty [DFHS24].⁶ Besides this, we discuss whether further meaningful notions arise by including the hiding feature in the framework.

Next to encompassing the existing BUFF notions, our approach aids the identification of gaps: Out of our 15 notions, the prior BUFF notions S-CEO, S-DEO, S-UEO, M-S-UEO, and MBS account for 5, while the remaining 10 have not been considered before. Our new framework completes the picture in two ways: Firstly, it introduces new variants of the existing BUFF notions in different attack modes (e.g., MBS in the HON and LEAK model), and secondly, it reveals the new notion class AM-S-M that has not been considered before. While this notion class does not reveal new attack vectors, it provides valuable insight on the relation between the existing notions as we elaborate in the following.

The known connection between S-CEO, S-DEO, and S-UEO in the HON model, transfers also to the other attack models, i.e., more generally we prove that AM-S-P decomposes into AM-[S,M]-P and AM-S-[M,P]. Moreover, the new notions class AM-S-M exhibits such a relation as well: namely AM-S-M holds if and only if AM-[S,P]-M and AM-S-[M,P] hold. This reveals a connection between “MBS-like” and “S-DEO-like” notions that is symmetric to the one between S-CEO and S-DEO. In particular, AM-S-[M,P] occupies a special position in this context as it is part of both relations. An illustration of this is provided in Fig. 1. This results in a hierarchy between the notions, where AM-S-P and AM-S-M imply all other notion classes. Taking into account the natural hierarchy MAL $\rightarrow$ LEAK $\rightarrow$ HON (in decreasing order of strength), we observe that the two notions MAL-S-P and MAL-S-M yield all others. When compared to the hierarchy in other frameworks for advanced security notions, we observe the following: For authenticated encryption, committing security notions form a hierarchy [MLGR23], where it suffices to target the strongest form as done, for instance, in [KSW24, NSS23], in the context of the NIST lightweight cryptography finalists [NIST15]. For key-encapsulation mechanisms, the notions by Cremers et al. [CDM24] do not form such a hierarchy with one notion implying all others. Instead, the picture is similar to what we observe in this work for signatures, that is, a few notions together imply all others. Thus, to be certain, one needs to show security with respect to all of these notions, e.g., as done in [KSW25], which developed a variant of the Fujisaki-Okamoto transform that achieves the required notions.

After having established the framework with its various relations, we turn towards achievability of the notions: For this we analyze the existing transforms for obtaining BUFF security in the context of our new framework. We consider the PS-1, PS-2, and PS-3 transforms from [PS05], as well as the BUFF-lite and BUFF transforms from [CDF⁺21]. The PS-3 transform has a unique advantage as it is the only one among the transforms that does not impose an increase in the signature size. However, its security is tied to the absence of so-called weak keys, which have appeared in previous works [PS05, CDF⁺21, DS24] with varying characterizations. As of now, it is known that the PS-3 transform fulfills HON-S-P

⁶ Note that in the meantime different proposals for a reworked NR definition have been proposed [CDF⁺21, DFF24, DFH⁺24].

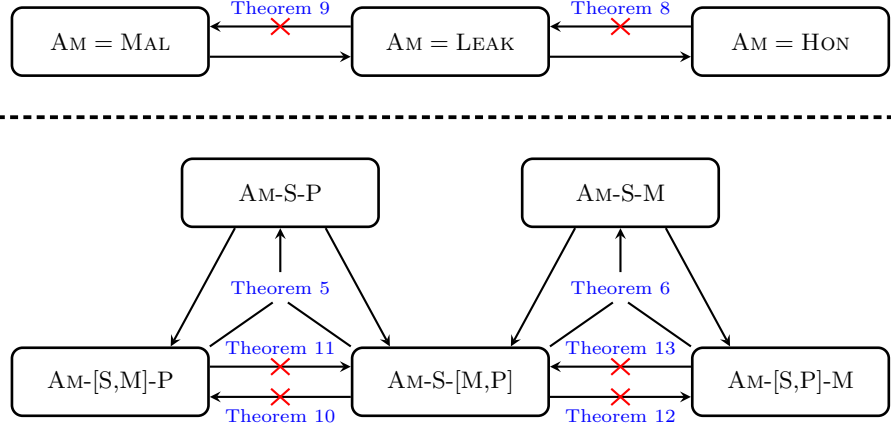


Fig. 1: Implications (arrows) and separations (crossed arrows) between the different attack models (upper part) and the different notion classes (lower part) with the theorems that establish the results (or none for trivial implications). The two notions $AM-S-P$ and $AM-S-M$ are the generalized notions while the remaining three notions $AM-[S,M]-P$, $AM-S-[M,P]$, and $AM-[S,P]-M$, are the restricted notions.

(i.e., S-UEO) security under the assumption that no weak keys exist. We address these gaps as follows: We provide a new formalization of weak keys and prove that a signature scheme for which these weak keys can be excluded achieves *all* notions from our framework. Regarding the remaining transforms, we show that the PS-1 and PS-2 transform yield a total of nine notations each—note that they overlap in three notions and together cover the complete framework. Lastly, we prove that the BUFF-lite (and thus in particular the BUFF) transform attain all notions from our framework. This reveals that we do not require a new transformation to achieve our notions as the BUFF(-lite) transform already fulfills the task.

Finally, we demonstrate that a slight modification of our notions allows to model the unforgeability notions—both existential and strong unforgeability.

1.2 Related Work

The beyond unforgeability features *message-bound signatures*, *exclusive ownership* (in its different forms), and *non-resignability*, were formalized in [CDF⁺21]. Message-bound signatures originate in [SPMS02], where the property was introduced using the term “duplicate signatures”. The exclusive ownership notions were introduced in [PS05] but the idea can be traced back further [BWM99, MS04]. Duplicate Signature Key Selection (DSKS) attacks, described in [KM11], correspond to exclusive ownership attacks, more precisely, S-CEO—HON-[S,M]-P in our framework. Non-resignability was first formalized in [CDF⁺21], based

on an attack from [JCCS19], but identified as flawed in [DFHS24]. The initial claims regarding the non-resignability of the BUFF transform were restored in [DFH⁺24].

Alongside the introduction of the beyond unforgeability features, Cremers et al. [CDF⁺21] analyzed the round-3 candidates in the NIST PQC standardization process [NIST17]: DILITHIUM, FALCON, RAINBOW, GEMSS, SPHINCS⁺, and PICNIC. Later, Düzl  et al. [DFF24] and D zl  and Struck [DS24] provided new results for FALCON and SPHINCS^{*}, respectively. Aulbach et al. [ADM⁺24] analyzed the signature schemes based on lattices, codes, isogenies, and multivariate equations, in the additional call for PQC-signatures by NIST [NIST22]. Kulkarni and Xagawa [KX24] did a similar analysis for the MPC-in-the-Head signatures. Emura [Emu24] analyzed ECDSA while Fischlin et al. [FMT25] considered BUFF security for threshold signature schemes. Meyer et al. [MSW25] proved better bounds regarding exclusive ownership notions for Fiat–Shamir signature schemes.

2 Preliminaries

In this section, we give the relevant background for this work. This entails the definition of signature schemes, its standard security notions—existential and strong unforgeability—and the BUFF notions. By adversary, we mean an efficient, i.e., probabilistic polynomial-time, algorithm with respect to a security parameter λ . We typically consider the security parameter to be implicit and do not state it explicitly. Furthermore, we write H to denote a random oracle that is used in the transformations later.

Definition 1. *A signature scheme S consists of three efficient algorithms:*

KeyGen(1^λ) $\rightarrow$ (pk, sk): *The key generation algorithm takes as input a security parameter and outputs a key pair (pk, sk).*

Sign(sk, msg) $\rightarrow sig$: *The signing algorithm takes as input a secret key sk and a message msg , and outputs a signature sig .*

Verify(pk, msg, sig) $\rightarrow v$: *The verification algorithm takes as input a public key pk , a message msg , and a signature sig , and it outputs a bit v .*

A signature scheme is said to be correct, if, for any $(pk, sk) \leftarrow KeyGen(1^\lambda)$ and any message msg , $Verify(pk, msg, Sign(sk, msg)) = 1$ holds with overwhelming probability.

Definition 2. *A signature scheme $S = (KeyGen, Sign, Verify)$ fulfills EUF-CMA and SUF-CMA if for any efficient adversary A , its probability in winning the corresponding game shown in Fig. 2 is negligible.*

Definition 3. *A signature scheme $S = (KeyGen, Sign, Verify)$ fulfills S-CEO, S-DEO, S-UEO, M-S-UEO, MBS, and wNR if for any efficient adversary A , its probability in winning the corresponding game shown in Fig. 3 is negligible.*

Game EUF-CMA	Game SUF-CMA
$(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{sk}) \leftarrow \text{\$KeyGen}()$	$(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{sk}) \leftarrow \text{\$KeyGen}()$
$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$
$(\mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\mathbf{sk}, \cdot)}(\mathbf{pk})$	$(\mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\mathbf{sk}, \cdot)}(\mathbf{pk})$
if $(\mathbf{msg}, \cdot) \in \mathcal{Q}$	if $(\mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) \in \mathcal{Q}$
return 0	return 0
return $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig})$	return $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig})$

Fig. 2: Security games EUF-CMA and SUF-CMA. We omit the sign oracle, which works in the obvious way and keeps track of the queries/responses via $\mathcal{Q}$.

3 Framework

In this section, we give a framework for binding properties of signature schemes, which includes the existing BUFF notions S-CEO, S-DEO, S-UEO, M-S-UEO, and MBS. We first introduce the various notions and subsequently show implications and separations between them. The connection of the framework to non-resignability and unforgeability is explained in [Section 5](#) and [Appendix A](#), respectively.

3.1 Formalization of Binding Notions

We deploy the systematic approach from [\[CDM24\]](#), i.e., we consider AM-B-T as a generic structure for each notion. The generic notions are displayed in [Fig. 4](#) and security is defined as follows.

Definition 4. *A signature scheme $\mathbf{S} = (\text{KeyGen}, \text{Sign}, \text{Verify})$ fulfills the notion X-BIND-P-Q if for any efficient adversary $\mathcal{A}$, its probability in winning the corresponding game shown in [Fig. 4](#) is negligible.*

The components B and T describe which component(s)—represented by B—bind which component(s)—represented by T. Since we are concerned with signature schemes, the relevant elements are the signature (S), the message (M), and the public key (P), i.e., $B, T \subseteq \{S, M, P\}$. For instance, AM-S-P, formalizes that the signature binds the public key. Speaking differently, it should be infeasible to find a signature (the binding component B) that verifies under two different public keys (the target component T). If B or T contain more than one element, we use square brackets for clarification, e.g., AM-[S,M]-P and AM-S-[M,P]. Note that to break, for example, AM-S-[M,P], a signature has to be found that verifies with $(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg})$ and $(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}})$, where $\mathbf{pk} \neq \overline{\mathbf{pk}}$ and $\mathbf{msg} \neq \overline{\mathbf{msg}}$, i.e., it does *not* suffice if only the public keys or only the messages differ.

The component AM describes the attack model and can take any value from $\{\text{HON}, \text{LEAK}, \text{MAL}\}$. The attack models describes the kind of access the adversary has to the key pairs. For AM = MAL (malicious setting), the adversary can

Game S-CEO $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{\$} \text{KeyGen}()$ $(sig, msg, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$ if $(msg, sig) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, sig)$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \wedge \overline{pk} \neq pk \rrbracket$	Game S-DEO $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{\$} \text{KeyGen}()$ $(sig, msg, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$ if $\exists \overline{msg} \neq msg \text{ s.t. } (\overline{msg}, sig) \in \mathcal{Q}$ $v_0 \leftarrow 1$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, sig)$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \wedge \overline{pk} \neq pk \rrbracket$
Game S-UEO $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $(sig, msg, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$ if $(\cdot, sig) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, sig)$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \wedge \overline{pk} \neq pk \rrbracket$	Game M-S-UEO $(sig, msg, \overline{msg}, pk, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$ $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, msg, sig)$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, \overline{msg}, sig)$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \wedge \overline{pk} \neq pk \rrbracket$
Game MBS $(sig, msg, \overline{msg}, pk) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$ $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, msg, sig)$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, \overline{msg}, sig)$ return $\llbracket msg \neq \overline{msg} \wedge v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	Game wNR $(sk, pk) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $msg \leftarrow \text{\$} \mathcal{M}$ $sig \leftarrow \text{\$} \text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $(\overline{sig}, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(pk, sig)$ $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket \overline{pk} \neq pk \wedge v = 1 \rrbracket$

Fig. 3: Security games S-CEO, S-DEO, S-UEO, M-S-UEO, MBS, and wNR. We omit the sign oracle, which works in the obvious way and keeps track of the queries/responses via $\mathcal{Q}$.

generate both key pairs (or the one key pair for notions which only allow for one public key, i.e., notions with $P \in B$) itself. For $AM = \text{HON}$ (honest setting), the adversary receives an honestly generated public key and can request signatures via the signing oracle; breaking the binding property then needs to involve a signature received from the signing oracle, i.e., an honestly generated signature. For $AM = \text{LEAK}$ (leakage setting), the key pair is honestly generated, as in the honest setting, but the adversary receives both public key *and* secret key—in particular the signing oracle is omitted as it becomes obsolete. We want to emphasize that in our notions the attack models differ from [CDM24] in how the target key pair is generated; the second key pair—if a notion asks for one—is

always chosen by the adversary, allowing it to be maliciously generated.⁷ This is in contrast to the binding notions for key-encapsulation mechanisms [CDM24], where the attack model concerns both keys. This difference stems from the fact that for key-encapsulation mechanisms, the adversary tries to disrupt the communication between two parties, whereas for signatures, the adversary wants to claim a signature for itself.

Depending on the attack model, the notion AM-S-P corresponds to two existing notions: For $AM = MAL$, it equals the notion M-S-UEO, while for $AM = HON$, it equals the notion S-UEO. On the other hand, for $AM = LEAK$, the notion does not correspond to any existing notion from prior literature. Similarly, our framework captures the remaining BUFF security notions. That is, S-CEO and S-DEO correspond to HON-[S,M]-P and HON-S-[M,P], respectively, while MBS equals MAL-[S,P]-M. When looking at prior literature, one can get the impression that MBS is “on the same level” as S-CEO, S-DEO, and S-UEO, while M-S-UEO corresponds to a stronger attack model. In light of our framework, however, MBS is actually closer to M-S-UEO (as both are in the malicious model) while the remaining notions are all in the honest model.

In total, one can consider a variety of 36 security notions: 12 combinations for B and T (6 containing all S, M, and P, and 6 containing only two out of those three) times the 3 attack models.

3.2 Meaningful Notions

Several of the notions turn out to be unachievable which we discuss here. We describe simple attacks for $AM = HON$, which restrict the adversary to using the provided signing oracle. The attacks easily extend to $AM \in \{LEAK, MAL\}$: for LEAK, the adversary can emulate the oracle with the secret key it receives as input, whereas for MAL, the adversary can simply generate the key pair(s) honestly and then proceed like in the LEAK setting. In the following reasoning, we exclude one-times signatures for which some arguments do not apply. The binding notions formalize security guarantees that are desired to be achieved by practical signatures. One-time signatures are typically used as underlying components to achieve practical (many-time) signatures, e.g., SPHINCS⁺. Thus, we believe the binding notions not to be of immediate interest for one-time signatures.

Messages itself are not Binding. The message itself cannot bind anything, making the notions AM-M-P, AM-M-S, and AM-M-[S,P] unachievable. The following attack works against all three notions: the adversary is given a public key $\mathbf{pk}$ and a matching sign oracle. Then, it generates a second key pair $(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \overline{\mathbf{sk}})$ using **KeyGen** and picks an arbitrary message $\mathbf{msg}$. The adversary, queries $\mathbf{msg}$ to the sign oracle resulting in a signature $\mathbf{sig}$, and computes $\overline{\mathbf{sig}}$ as the signature

⁷ However, note that the attacker only ever has to output the public key—never the secret one. In contrast, the initial notions from [PS05] required the adversary to also output the secret key.

Game MAL-B-T $(\text{sig}, \overline{\text{sig}}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$ if $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}) = 0$ return 0 if $\text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{sig}}) = 0$ return 0 return $\llbracket (\forall X \in B \ x = \overline{x}) \wedge$ $(\forall Y \in T \ y \neq \overline{y}) \rrbracket$	Game LEAK-B-T $(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $(\text{sig}, \overline{\text{sig}}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\text{pk}, \text{sk})$ if $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}) = 0$ return 0 if $\text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{sig}}) = 0$ return 0 return $\llbracket (\forall X \in B \ x = \overline{x}) \wedge$ $(\forall Y \in T \ y \neq \overline{y}) \rrbracket$
Game HON-B-T $(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $(\text{sig}, \overline{\text{sig}}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \cdot)}(\text{pk})$ if $(\text{msg}, \text{sig}) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $\text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{sig}}) = 0$ return 0 return $\llbracket (\forall X \in B \ x = \overline{x}) \wedge (\forall Y \in T \ y \neq \overline{y}) \rrbracket$	Oracle $\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$ $\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$ $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \mathcal{Q} \cup \{(\text{msg}, \text{sig})\}$ return sig

Fig. 4: Generic game for the three attack modes MAL, LEAK, and HON. Note that $B, T \subseteq \{S, M, P\}$ and for $X, Y \in B, T$, we denote by $x, \overline{x}, y, \overline{y}$ the corresponding outputs of the adversary, i.e., for $X = M$, we have $x = \text{msg}$ and $\overline{x} = \overline{\text{msg}}$. Note that for HON-B-T, $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}) = 1$ holds by correctness (as this tuple has to stem from a signing query).

of msg under $\overline{\text{sk}}$. These signatures will most likely differ and by correctness, they verify under the respective public keys.

Public Keys itself are not Binding. Similarly to the message, also the public key itself cannot bind anything. This makes the following notions unachievable: AM-P-M, AM-P-S, and AM-P-[S,M]. An adversary receiving a public key pk , can simply query two distinct messages msg and $\overline{\text{msg}}$ to the signing oracle receiving two (likely to be different) signatures sig and $\overline{\text{sig}}$.

Messages and Public Keys together are not Binding. Finally, messages and public keys together do not bind the signature in the case of probabilistic signature schemes. An adversary receiving a public key can query an arbitrary message msg twice to the signing oracle to receive two different signatures sig and $\overline{\text{sig}}$. In case of deterministic or derandomized signature schemes, the argument does not apply. Instead, we can argue that the notion in the honest

setting, i.e., HON-[M,P]-S, is implied by SUF-CMA security.⁸ In case of the leakage and malicious setting, we further need to distinguish between deterministic signature schemes, like RSA-FDH, and derandomized signature schemes, like ML-DSA without hedging. For the latter, the notions remain unachievable by the same attack as described for probabilistic signature schemes: the simple reason is that the adversary can locally compute two signatures using the *randomized* version of the signing algorithm. For the former, one can argue that security is trivially fulfilled in case of signature schemes, where, for a fixed pair of message and public key, there is a *unique* signature that is valid (e.g., RSA-FDH). Note that the argument does not cover deterministic signature schemes for which there are multiple signatures for the same pair of message and public key. By nature of deterministic signing, the sign algorithm will only output one of these signatures. If the others can be found by merely having the public key, the signature scheme would not be SUF-CMA secure. In theory, however, one might imagine a signature scheme where such signatures exist that are hard to find given only the public key but become easy to find when having access to the secret key. We are not aware of any reasonable example for such a signature scheme and leave a more formal treatment of this part as an open problem.

Signatures are Binding. The results above show that the relevant notions are those where the signature binds other values. In case of probabilistic signatures, other notions are not achievable as discussed above. For other signature schemes (derandomized or deterministic ones) the notions are either also not achieved or trivially satisfied. Thus, we can restrict our focus to notions where $S \in B$. This leaves us with the 5 notion classes AM-S-[M,P], AM-[S,P]-M, AM-[S,M]-P, AM-S-M, and AM-S-P and a total of 15 binding notions, when taking the attack model into account. These notions cover the existing BUFF security notions MBS, S-CEO, S-DEO, S-UEO, and M-S-UEO. Implications and separations between the different notion classes and attack models are illustrated in Fig. 1. The generic notions MAL-B-T, LEAK-B-T, and HON-B-T are depicted in Fig. 4, while all 15 individual notions are given in Appendix C.

3.3 Implications

In this section we discuss the implications between the different notion classes AM-S-P, AM-S-M, AM-[S,M]-P, AM-S-[M,P], and AM-[S,P]-M. In the following, we will refer to the former two as the *generalized notions*, in the sense that they are less restricted by only involving two out of the three components (signature, message, and public key), and the latter three as the *restricted notions*.

There are some trivial implications from generalized notions to restricted notions. For instance, if the signature binds the public key, then signature and

⁸ An adversary $\mathcal{A}$ finding a message $\mathbf{msg}$ and two distinct signatures $\mathbf{sig}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{sig}}$ without querying $\mathbf{msg}$ to the sign oracle immediately implies a forgery attack; if $\mathcal{A}$ did query $\mathbf{msg}$ and, w.l.o.g., receives $\mathbf{sig}$, then the tuple $(\mathbf{msg}, \overline{\mathbf{sig}})$ constitutes a forgery in the sense of SUF-CMA.

message *together* bind the public key. This yields the implication $\text{AM-S-P} \Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,M]-P}$. At the same time, if the signature binds any of the other two values (message or public key), it also binds the pair of both, e.g., $\text{AM-S-P} \Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]}$. Overall, we obtain the following trivial implications:

$$\begin{array}{ll} \text{AM-S-P} \Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,M]-P} & \text{AM-S-M} \Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,P]-M} \\ \text{AM-S-P} \Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]} & \text{AM-S-M} \Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]} \end{array}$$

An interesting aspect is that each generalized notion implies two restricted notions; AM-[S,M]-P and AM-[S,P]-M are each implied by one of the two generalized notions while AM-S-[M,P] is implied by both. It turns out that the implications also hold in the other direction, meaning that two restricted notions together imply the generalized notion that implies them. This is formalized in the following two theorems. Note that the first one was already shown in [CDF⁺21], as it corresponds to the relation that S-CEO and S-DEO together imply S-UEO. The second one is new, since the generalized notion AM-S-M is novel.

Theorem 5. *For $\text{AM} \in \{\text{HON}, \text{LEAK}, \text{MAL}\}$, a signature scheme $\mathbf{S}$ is AM-S-P secure if and only if it is both AM-[S,M]-P and AM-S-[M,P] secure.*

Proof. The implication $\text{AM-S-P} \Rightarrow (\text{AM-[S,M]-P} \wedge \text{AM-S-[M,P]})$, follows directly from the trivial implications $\text{AM-S-P} \Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,M]-P}$ and $\text{AM-S-P} \Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]}$ discussed above the theorem. For the reverse direction, we show that an attack against AM-S-P , yields an attack against either AM-[S,M]-P or AM-S-[M,P] . For this, note that an AM-S-P attack requires two different public keys, but only one signature. This can be achieved using one message or two different ones—in the former case the attack breaks the notion AM-[S,M]-P , and in the latter case the notion AM-S-[M,P] . $\square$

Theorem 6. *For $\text{AM} \in \{\text{HON}, \text{LEAK}, \text{MAL}\}$, a signature scheme $\mathbf{S}$ is AM-S-M secure if and only if it is both AM-S-[M,P] and AM-[S,P]-M secure.*

Proof. The statement directly follows from the definitions of the notions using the same reasoning of the previous proof. $\square$

Remark 7. Theorem 6 shows an interesting connection, namely that the existing BUFF security notions MBS (AM-[S,P]-M) and S-DEO (AM-S-[M,P]) together imply our new notion AM-S-M . This means that MBS (AM-[S,P]-M) and S-DEO (AM-S-[M,P]) exhibit the same relation to AM-S-M as S-CEO (AM-[S,M]-P) and S-DEO (AM-S-[M,P]) exhibit towards S-UEO (AM-S-P). In prior works, the nomenclature clearly indicates a connection between S-CEO (AM-[S,M]-P) and S-DEO (AM-S-[M,P]). On the other hand, MBS (AM-[S,P]-M) typically seems to be a different security notion. Our framework reveals that MBS and S-DEO in fact are related as well, which also shows that S-DEO plays a central role as it is connected to both other restricted notions S-CEO and MBS—which itself are not directly related.

3.4 Separations

The following two theorems show separations for notions of the same notion class but different attack models (first separating honest and leakage setting, followed by separating leakage and malicious setting). The first theorem shows that security in the honest setting does not imply security in the leakage setting while the second theorem shows that security in the leakage setting does not yield security in the malicious setting. Clearly, to make the statements of the two theorems not vacuous, we need schemes that satisfy the requirements. Looking ahead, we will later see how to achieve all security notions, which thus shows that there are schemes satisfying the requirements of [Theorem 8](#) and [Theorem 9](#).

The theorem below states that security for HON notions does not imply security for LEAK notions. It relies on the signature scheme shown in [Fig. 5](#). Here, a random value x is added to the secret key while the output y of x under a one-way function is added to the public key. Signatures have an additional component z such that if z is a preimage of y , the signature will always be accepted. This change does not affect security for HON notions as honest signatures will always have $z = \perp$. For LEAK notions, the adversary can easily obtain a preimage from the secret key.

Theorem 8. *Let $\mathbf{S}$ be a signature scheme, $\mathbf{F}$ be a one-way function, and $\mathbf{S}^*$ be the signature scheme displayed in [Fig. 5](#). Then the following statements hold:*

1. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is HON-[S,P]-M, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is HON-[S,P]-M but not LEAK-[S,P]-M*
2. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is HON-S-[M,P], then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is HON-S-[M,P] but not LEAK-S-[M,P]*
3. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is HON-[S,M]-P, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is HON-[S,M]-P but not LEAK-[S,M]-P*
4. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is HON-S-M, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is HON-S-M but not LEAK-S-M*
5. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is HON-S-P, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is HON-S-P but not LEAK-S-P*

Proof. Observe that $\mathbf{S}^*$ is identical to $\mathbf{S}$ unless a signature contains the preimage x of the value y appended to the public key in which case the special case for verification is triggered which accepts the signature for any message. Note further that honestly generated signatures never trigger the special case for verification.

Regarding the HON notions, observe that an adversary $\mathcal{A}$ is restricted to honestly generated signatures and hence every signature will be of the form $(\mathbf{sig}, \perp)$. Hence the check $z \neq \perp$ will never succeed, i.e., $\mathcal{A}$ cannot trigger the special verification case. This establishes that $\mathbf{S}^*$ inherits HON-[S,P]-M, HON-S-[M,P], and HON-[S,M]-P security from the underlying signature scheme $\mathbf{S}$.

Regarding LEAK-[S,P]-M, the following attack is possible. Given an honestly generated key pair $(\mathbf{pk}^*, \mathbf{sk}^*)$, with $\mathbf{pk}^* = (\mathbf{pk}, y)$ and $\mathbf{sk}^* = (\mathbf{sk}, x)$, an adversary $\mathcal{A}$ can pick an arbitrary signature $\mathbf{sig}$, set $\mathbf{sig}^* \leftarrow (\mathbf{sig}, x)$, and output $(\mathbf{sig}^*, \mathbf{msg}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}})$ for arbitrary messages $\mathbf{msg} \neq \overline{\mathbf{msg}}$. Since $\mathbf{F}(x) = y$, $\mathbf{sig}^*$ triggers the special case for verification which accepts irrespectively of the message, i.e., $\text{Verify}^*(\mathbf{pk}^*, \cdot, \mathbf{sig}^*) = 1$.

Regarding LEAK-S-[M,P], the following attack is possible. Given an honestly generated key pair $(\mathbf{pk}^*, \mathbf{sk}^*)$, with $\mathbf{pk}^* = (\mathbf{pk}, y)$ and $\mathbf{sk}^* = (\mathbf{sk}, x)$, an adversary $\mathcal{A}$ can pick an arbitrary signature $\mathbf{sig}$, set $\mathbf{sig}^* \leftarrow (\mathbf{sig}, x)$. Furthermore, $\mathcal{A}$ sets

$\overline{\text{pk}}^* \leftarrow (\overline{\text{pk}}, y)$, for $\overline{\text{pk}} \neq \text{pk}$ and outputs $(\text{sig}^*, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}^*)$. By construction, the public keys and messages are different, and, since $F(x) = y$, sig^* triggers the special case for verification which accepts irrespectively of the message, i.e., $\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}^*, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*) = \text{Verify}^*(\overline{\text{pk}}^*, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig}^*) = 1$.

Regarding LEAK-[S,M]-P, the above attack for LEAK-S-[M,P] applies, with the mere difference that $\mathcal{A}$ only picks a single message that it outputs.

Lastly, the above results together with [Theorem 5](#) and [Theorem 6](#) imply that LEAK-S-P and LEAK-S-M are not fulfilled. $\square$

Note that the theorem also holds without using a one-way function to “hide” the value x in the public key. By using a one-way function, the transformed scheme remains unforgeable. While not strictly necessary, one might wonder how relevant the separation is, if the scheme does not achieve the minimum security though, which is why we opted to make use of it.

The next theorem establishes the separation between the leakage setting and the malicious setting and relies on the signature scheme shown in [Fig. 6](#). Here, both public keys and signatures have a trailing bit. For honestly generated keys and signature, the bits are 1. Honestly generated public keys can only verify signatures with a trailing 1, in which case the normal verification algorithm is done. Malicious public keys (having a trailing 0) will accept any malicious signature (also having a trailing 0). If the trailing bits of public key and signature are different, verification will always fail. In the leakage setting, the adversary receives an honestly generated key pair, which will have a trailing 1 and thus can never trigger the special case of verification. However, in the malicious setting, the adversary can simply choose public key and signature with trailing 0s to trigger the special verification check.

Theorem 9. *Let $\mathbf{S}$ be a signature scheme and $\mathbf{S}^*$ be the signature scheme displayed in [Fig. 6](#). Then the following statements hold:*

1. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is LEAK-[S,P]-M, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is LEAK-[S,P]-M but not MAL-[S,P]-M*
2. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is LEAK-S-[M,P], then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is LEAK-S-[M,P] but not MAL-S-[M,P]*
3. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is LEAK-[S,M]-P, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is LEAK-[S,M]-P but not MAL-[S,M]-P*
4. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is LEAK-S-M, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is LEAK-S-M but not MAL-S-M*
5. *if $\mathbf{S}$ is LEAK-S-P, then $\mathbf{S}^*$ is LEAK-S-P but not MAL-S-P*

Proof. Regarding the LEAK notions, observe that the honestly generated public key that an adversary $\mathcal{A}$ obtains will have a trailing 1. By construction, this public key can only verify signatures that have a trailing 1 as well. In this case, however, $\mathbf{S}^*$ is identical to $\mathbf{S}$, hence LEAK-[S,P]-M, LEAK-S-[M,P], and LEAK-[S,M]-P security of $\mathbf{S}^*$ is inherited from the respective security of $\mathbf{S}$.

Regarding the MAL notions, observe that $\mathbf{S}^*$ accepts everything if both public key and signature have a trailing 0. An adversary $\mathcal{A}$ can pick two different public keys $\text{pk}^* \leftarrow (\text{pk}, 0)$ and $\overline{\text{pk}}^* \leftarrow (\overline{\text{pk}}, 0)$ and an arbitrary signature $\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, 0)$, all with a trailing 0. By construction, $\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}^*, \cdot, \text{sig}^*) = \text{Verify}^*(\overline{\text{pk}}^*, \cdot, \text{sig}^*) = 1$, irrespectively of the message. Depending on the exact notion, $\mathcal{A}$ outputs $(\text{sig}^*, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk}^*)$ (MAL-[S,P]-M), $(\text{sig}^*, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk}^*, \overline{\text{pk}}^*)$

$\text{KeyGen}^*(\cdot)$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}^*, \text{msg})$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}^*, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$(\text{sk}, x) \leftarrow \text{sk}^*$	$(\text{pk}, y) \leftarrow \text{pk}^*$
$x \leftarrow \mathcal{X}$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$(\text{sig}, z) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$
$y \leftarrow F(x)$	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, \perp)$	if $\llbracket z \neq \perp \wedge F(z) = y \rrbracket$
$\text{sk}^* \leftarrow (\text{sk}, x)$	return sig^*	return 1
$\text{pk}^* \leftarrow (\text{pk}, y)$		return $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
return $(\text{pk}^*, \text{sk}^*)$		

Fig. 5: Separation example for $\text{HON-B-T} \not\Rightarrow \text{LEAK-B-T}$ ([Theorem 8](#)).

(MAL-S-[M,P]), or $(\text{sig}^*, \text{msg}, \text{pk}^*, \overline{\text{pk}}^*)$ (MAL-[S,M]-P) to break the corresponding security notion.

The above results together with [Theorem 5](#) and [Theorem 6](#) imply that LEAK-S-P and LEAK-S-M are not fulfilled. $\square$

The following theorems show separations between the various restricted notions. In particular, we show the following separation:

$$\begin{array}{ll}
\text{AM-S-[M,P]} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,M]-P} & \text{AM-S-[M,P]} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,P]-M} \\
\text{AM-[S,M]-P} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]} & \text{AM-[S,P]-M} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]}
\end{array}$$

The proofs are deferred to [Appendix B](#). The first two separations ($\text{AM-S-[M,P]} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,M]-P}$ and $\text{AM-[S,M]-P} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]}$) are due to [\[CDF⁺21\]](#); we merely recast them in our framework and argue that they hold for all three attack models (the corresponding results in [\[CDF⁺21\]](#) consider only the HON case where $\text{AM} = \text{HON}$). For the third separation, we give a new construction. For the forth separation, we do not use an artificial signature scheme but UOV, leveraging the results by Aulbach et al. [\[ADM⁺24\]](#). For all separations, the proofs hold regardless of the attack model.

Theorem 10 ($\text{AM-S-[M,P]} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,M]-P}$). *There exists a signature scheme that is AM-S-[M,P] but not AM-[S,M]-P.*

Theorem 11 ($\text{AM-[S,M]-P} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]}$). *There exists a signature scheme that is AM-[S,M]-P but not AM-S-[M,P].*

Theorem 12 ($\text{AM-S-[M,P]} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,P]-M}$). *There exists a signature scheme that is AM-S-[M,P] but not AM-[S,P]-M.*

Theorem 13 ($\text{AM-[S,P]-M} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-S-[M,P]}$). *There exists a signature scheme that is AM-[S,P]-M but not AM-S-[M,P].*

$\text{KeyGen}^*(\cdot)$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}^*, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$(\text{pk}, b) \leftarrow \text{pk}^*$
$\text{pk}^* \leftarrow (\text{pk}, 1)$	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, 1)$	$(\text{sig}, d) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$
return (pk^*, sk)	return sig^*	if $\llbracket b \neq d \rrbracket$
		return 0
		if $\llbracket b = 0 \wedge d = 0 \rrbracket$
		return 1
		if $\llbracket b = 1 \wedge d = 1 \rrbracket$
		return $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$

Fig. 6: Separation example for $\text{LEAK-B-T} \not\Rightarrow \text{MAL-B-T}$ (Theorem 9).

4 Analysis of Transformations

In this section, we analyze the existing transformations that achieve (partial) BUFF security with respect to our expanded framework. There are a total of five transformations: PS-1, PS-2, PS-3, BUFF-lite, and BUFF. We start with a description of these transforms and the known results regarding the BUFF notions they achieve in Section 4.1. Out of these transforms, only one—the PS-3 transform—does not increase the signature size, which offers a significant benefit. Thus, we start with the analysis of the PS-3 transform in Section 4.2, and analyze the signature-increasing transforms, i.e., the PS-1, PS-2, BUFF-lite, and BUFF transform in Section 4.3. Lastly, in Section 4.4, we give an updated overview of the results for the transformations with respect to our new framework.

Whenever we give an overview of existing results in the following, we will use the BUFF nomenclature from prior works and assign our new notation in brackets. Otherwise, we will stick to our new naming convention.

4.1 Overview of the existing Transformations

Firstly, there are three transformations that were introduced in [PS05] and further analyzed in [CDF⁺21]: PS-1, PS-2, and PS-3. For a signature scheme $\mathbf{S}$, the signature after application of the PS-1 transform (shown in Fig. 7) is $\text{sig} = (\mathbf{S}.\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg}), \text{H}(\text{msg}))$ and it was proven that—out of the BUFF notions—the resulting scheme achieves S-DEO (HON-S-[M,P]) and MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M). For the PS-2 transform (shown in Fig. 7), the signature is given as $\text{sig} = (\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg}), \text{H}(\text{pk}))$ and a transformed scheme achieves M-S-UEO (MAL-S-P). For the PS-3 transform (shown in Fig. 7), the signature is computed as $\text{sig} = \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{H}(\text{msg}, \text{pk}))$ and the transform achieves S-UEO (HON-S-P) security requiring some additional assumption related to weak keys.

Next to this, [CDF⁺21] introduced two further transforms: the BUFF-lite and the BUFF transform. For the BUFF-lite transform (shown in Fig. 8), signatures are of the form $\text{sig} = (\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg}), \text{H}(\text{msg}, \text{pk}))$ and M-S-UEO (MAL-S-P)

$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{h} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$
$\text{h} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{msg})$	$\text{h} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk})$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{h})$
$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, \text{h})$	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, \text{h})$	return sig
return sig*	return sig*	
$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
$(\text{sig}, \text{h}) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$	$(\text{sig}, \text{h}) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$	$\text{h} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$
$\bar{\text{h}} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{msg})$	$\bar{\text{h}} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk})$	$\text{v} \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{h}, \text{sig})$
$\text{v} \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	$\text{v} \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	return $\llbracket \text{v} = 1 \rrbracket$
return $\llbracket \text{v} = 1 \wedge \bar{\text{h}} = \text{h} \rrbracket$	return $\llbracket \text{v} = 1 \wedge \bar{\text{h}} = \text{h} \rrbracket$	

Fig. 7: Transforms PS-1 (left), PS-2 (middle), and PS-3 (right).

$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{h} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$
$\text{h} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{h})$
$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, \text{h})$	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, \text{h})$
return sig*	return sig*
$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$
$(\text{sig}, \text{h}) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$	$(\text{sig}, \text{h}) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$
$\bar{\text{h}} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$	$\bar{\text{h}} \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$
$\text{v} \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	$\text{v} \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \bar{\text{h}}, \text{sig})$
return $\llbracket \text{v} = 1 \wedge \bar{\text{h}} = \text{h} \rrbracket$	return $\llbracket \text{v} = 1 \wedge \bar{\text{h}} = \text{h} \rrbracket$

Fig. 8: Transforms BUFF-lite (left) and BUFF (right).

and MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M) are achieved. The BUFF transform (shown in Fig. 8) computes signatures as $\text{sig} = (\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{H}(\text{msg}, \text{pk})), \text{H}(\text{msg}, \text{pk}))$ and achieves M-S-UEO (MAL-S-P), MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M) and NR. An overview of the existing positive results for the different transforms is given in Table 1.

To summarize, all of the transforms either append a hash value to the signature (PS-1, PS-2, and BUFF-lite) or sign not the message but the hash of message and public key (PS-3)—or do both (BUFF). In particular, for all transforms, the signing time increases while for all except PS-3 also the signature size increases.

4.2 Analysis of the PS-3 Transform

The PS-3 transform is of special interest, as it is the only transform that does not increase the signature size. At the same time, its analysis is the most involved, as so-called weak keys have to be taken into account. This observation

Table 1: Positive results from prior works [PS05, CDF⁺21] regarding the five existing transforms. The asterisks in the PS-3 column indicate that the results are tied to an assumption (absence of weak keys). The symbols $\blacktriangleright$ denote that the results follow directly from the existing ones using the hierarchy of notions. An overview of our new results is given in Fig. 12 and Fig. 13.

	PS-1			PS-2			PS-3			BUFF-lite			BUFF		
	M	L	H	M	L	H	M	L	H	M	L	H	M	L	H
AM-S-M	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?	?
AM-[S,P]-M	✓	$\blacktriangleright$	$\blacktriangleright$	?	?	?	?	?	?	✓	$\blacktriangleright$	$\blacktriangleright$	✓	$\blacktriangleright$	$\blacktriangleright$
AM-S-[M,P]	?	?	✓	?	?	✓	?	?	✓*	?	?	✓	?	?	✓
AM-[S,M]-P	?	?	?	?	?	✓	?	?	✓*	?	?	✓	?	?	✓
AM-S-P	?	?	?	✓	$\blacktriangleright$	✓	?	?	✓*	✓	$\blacktriangleright$	✓	✓	$\blacktriangleright$	✓

has been made in various prior works, starting with the very first paper [PS05]. Here, a property for signatures schemes is defined, which requires that for each public key $\mathbf{pk}$ and signature $\mathbf{sig}$ —that have passed some basic correctness tests implemented by the verifier—the fraction of messages $\mathbf{msg}$ in the message space for which $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$, is negligible. Note that this property is not restricted to honestly generated keys, but also comprises ones outside the image of key generation—as such can also be chosen by an adversary in the S-UEO (HON-S-P) game. Under this assumption, the PS-3 transform suffices to achieve S-UEO (HON-S-P)⁹ security.

In [CDF⁺21], weak keys are informally described as keys that verify multiple or even all messages and it is shown that—contrary to the intuition—weak keys cannot only occur outside of the space of honestly generated keys. This means that it does not suffice for the verifier to check whether a key is in the image of KeyGen to obtain S-UEO (HON-S-P) just from the PS-3 transform. In particular, it seems that one cannot get around weak keys when analyzing the PS-3 transform. Next to the S-UEO (HON-S-P) results, [CDF⁺21] also describe that the remaining BUFF properties M-S-UEO (MAL-S-P), MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M), and NR¹⁰ cannot be achieved by the PS-3 transform without any additional assumptions.

In [DS24], the connection between MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M) and weak keys (as characterized in [CDF⁺21]) is brought to attention: as MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M) excludes that an adversary can find a public key that verifies two messages for

⁹ In [PS05] the slightly weaker notion UEO is considered, where the adversary is not provided access to a signing oracle but only a single pair of message and signature instead. However, in [CDF⁺21] it was shown that all results from [PS05] regarding UEO security transfer to the stronger notion S-UEO.

¹⁰ Note that this result is with respect to the old non-resignability definition, which has been proven faulty [DFHS24].

the same signature, it especially prevents the adversary from finding a public key that verifies many messages. Under the assumption that the underlying signature scheme, i.e., *before* applying PS-3, achieves MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M), [DS24] shows that the PS-3 transform suffices to achieve S-UEO (HON-S-P) and wNR while maintaining MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M). However, there are two disadvantages: First, the resulting bound for S-UEO (HON-S-P) is quite loose, which leaves room for improvement. Second, the result comes with an explicit counter example that PS-3 does *not* achieve M-S-UEO (MAL-S-P) security.

While MBS (MAL-[S,P]-M) excludes weak keys as defined in [CDF⁺21], it does not exclude the existence of public keys $\mathbf{pk}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{pk}}$ for which, given two random messages $\mathbf{msg}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{msg}}$, one can find a signature $\mathbf{sig}$ such that $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$ and $\text{Verify}(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$ hold with non-negligible probability. Then the following M-S-UEO (MAL-S-P) attack against a PS-3-transformed scheme is possible—even if the underlying scheme fulfilled MBS (HON-[S,P]-M) security—: Firstly, pick two keys $\mathbf{pk}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{pk}}$ with the described property; secondly choose arbitrary $\mathbf{msg}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{msg}}$ and compute $\mathbf{h} = H(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg})$ and $\overline{\mathbf{h}} = H(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}})$; thirdly, determine $\mathbf{sig}$ such that $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{h}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$ and $\text{Verify}(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \overline{\mathbf{h}}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$. In [DS24], it is shown that such keys exist for the multivariate signature scheme UOV [BCD⁺23].

In summary, the security of PS-3-transformed schemes regarding the various notions we consider (and introduce) in this work, is quite unclear. The PS-3 transform achieves HON-S-P (under some conditions related to weak keys) while it generally does not achieve MAL-S-P. Furthermore, it is known that the PS-3 transform maintains MAL-[S,P]-M security of the underlying signature scheme (which then also yields the required conditions to achieve HON-S-P). The situation for several other notions (MAL-[S,M]-P, MAL-S-[M,P], LEAK-S-P, LEAK-[S,M]-P, LEAK-S-[M,P]) is unclear at the moment.

In the following we will give an updated formal weak key definition and prove that for a scheme without such weak keys, the PS-3 transform suffices to achieve *all* notions from our framework introduced in Section 3. In particular, this definition covers also the kind of keys that allow the MAL-S-P attack against UOV in [DS24]. Also, while our result requires a scheme-specific analysis to check for weak keys, it can yield better bounds.

In the following we give a rigorous definition of weak keys.

Definition 14. *For a signature scheme $\mathbf{S}$, we call a public key $\mathbf{pk}$ of this scheme weak if there is an adversary $\mathcal{A}$ such that the probability*

$$\Pr[\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1 \mid \mathbf{sig} \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}), \mathbf{msg} \leftarrow^* \mathcal{M}]$$

is non-negligible.

Compared to the literature, our weak key definition is closest to the one from [PS05]. Here, a scheme is said to have no weak keys if for each public key $\mathbf{pk}$ and signature $\mathbf{sig}$, the fraction of messages $\mathbf{msg}$ in the message space for which $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$, is negligible. However, this definition does not involve an adversary, but is a general property of the signature scheme.

Regarding the relation between the notions, one easily observes that weak keys by definition of [PS05] are also weak in our setting, while we will prove the converse to be false. In the following, we show that, while being harder to fulfill, our definition allows to achieve all notions from our framework. In contrast, we prove that the weak key definition following [PS05] is *not* sufficient. We consider the transform T described in Fig. 9 that adapts signing by appending $\perp$ to each signature. Further, verification of a message msg and a signature $\text{sig}^* = (\text{sig}, b)$ works as follows: if $b = \perp$, **Verify** of the underlying schemes is called, if $b \neq \perp$, output 1 if and only if $b = \text{msg}$ and 0 otherwise. We consider a signature scheme S that has no weak keys according to the definition of [PS05] and observe that this property is preserved after application of the transform from Fig. 9. This is due to the fact that $T(S)$ verifies only exactly one message more for each pair of public key and signature. In particular, if the fraction of messages verifying a pair of public key and signature was negligible before application of the transform, that will also be the case after. In contrast, for the transformed scheme $T(S)$ all keys are weak by our definition: Given a public key and a random message msg , the adversary can always output $\text{sig}^* = (\text{sig}, \text{msg})$ for an arbitrarily chosen sig . By definition of the transform, sig^* will verify for the message msg via the special verification case. In summary, this shows that weak keys in our definition are not necessarily weak in the definition by [PS05] and thus our definition is strictly stronger.

Next, we argue why this stronger definition is necessary for achieving all notions from the new framework. For this, we consider the above scheme after additionally applying the PS-3 transform. Note that this scheme still has no weak keys as defined in [PS05]. The following LEAK-[S,M]-P attack against PS-3[T[S]] is possible: Given (pk, sk) , the adversary chooses a random message msg , signature sig , and public key $\overline{\text{pk}} \neq \text{pk}$. Then, $\text{sig}^* = (\text{sig}, \text{msg})$ will verify under both pk and $\overline{\text{pk}}$.¹¹

Remark 15. Definition 14 could also be formulated in a way that does not completely exclude the existence of weak keys, but instead just requires that it is computationally hard to find such keys. While the latter variant would be more general, we opt for the former one, as in all examples we are aware of, there are either no weak keys or the ones that exist are easy to find.

Note that, our weak key definition is not restricted to keys in the image of **KeyGen** as an adversary in the MAL games can choose also maliciously generated keys. In the following we give a number of examples for schemes with weak keys: The SCHNORR signature scheme [Sch91] has two weak keys that lie outside the image of **KeyGen**, while for Lyubashevsky’s signature scheme [Lyu12] and the multivariate signature scheme UOV [BCD⁺24], also weak keys inside the image exist.

Weak Keys of the SCHNORR Signature Scheme. The SCHNORR signature scheme is displayed in Fig. 10. For a weak key $\text{pk} = Z$ of the SCHNORR signature

¹¹ Note that this attack does not apply against HON-S-[M,P], as the signature has to stem from an query to the sign oracle (and hence will be of the form $\text{sig}^* = (\text{sig}, \perp)$).

scheme, there has to be an adversary $\mathcal{A}$, such that, given $\mathbf{pk}$ and an arbitrary message $\mathbf{msg}$, $\mathcal{A}$ finds a signature $\mathbf{sig} = (e, s)$ with $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$, i.e., $H(\mathbf{msg}, g^s Z^{-e}) = e$ with non-negligible probability. Firstly note that by varying e also the target value of the hash computation is changed (i.e., this is a moving target). On the other hand, for some fixed e , the problem of finding a matching s requires solving a discrete logarithm problem.

However, the cases $\mathbf{pk} = Z \in \{0, 1\}$ represent exceptions, in which the moving target problem can be bypassed—note that these values never occur during honest key generation as honestly generated keys are of the form $\mathbf{pk} = Z = g^z$ for $z \leftarrow^* [q-1]$ and g a generator of order q .¹² Simply put, for $\mathbf{pk} = Z \in \{0, 1\}$, e does not influence the value of $g^s Z^{-e}$. Given a random message $\mathbf{msg}$, the adversary chooses a random value for s , computes $H(\mathbf{msg}, g^s)$ and sets e to be the result of the latter computation. Then $H(\mathbf{msg}, g^s Z^{-e}) = e$ will hold, i.e., the signature (s, e) verifies.

So in conclusion, the SCHNORR signature scheme has two weak keys, namely $\mathbf{pk} = Z \in \{0, 1\}$, which are not in the image of KeyGen .

Weak Keys in Lyubashevsky’s Signature Scheme. We consider Lyubashevsky’s signature scheme [Lyu12] as described in Fig. 11 based on the SIS problem. For a weak key $\mathbf{pk} = (A, T)$ of this signature scheme, there has to be an adversary $\mathcal{A}$, such that, given $\mathbf{pk}$ and an arbitrary message $\mathbf{msg}$, $\mathcal{A}$ finds a signature $\mathbf{sig} = (z, c)$ with $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$, i.e., $\|z\| \leq \eta\sigma\sqrt{m}$ and $c = H(Az - Tc, \mathbf{msg})$. As for the SCHNORR signature scheme, varying c changes the target of the hash computation (i.e., this is again a moving target problem) and for a fixed c , finding a matching *short* z requires solving an SIS problem.

Thus, there are two types of weak keys: Those for which we can circumvent the moving target problem and those for which the SIS problem is not hard. For the former, all public keys of the form $(A, 0)$ for $A \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times m}$ act as weak keys: for $T = 0$, c does not influence the value of $Az - Tc$ and thus c can be chosen *after* the hash is computed. Note that this works analogously to the attack described for the SCHNORR signature scheme. Further, we observe that these keys lie in the image of KeyGen as for $S = 0$ all $(A, 0)$ with $A \in \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times m}$ can occur as public keys. However, it is extremely unlikely for such a key to be the result of an honest key generation and these cases are easily excluded by checking whether $T = 0$ during verification.

The other type of weak keys cannot be described as concretely: It comprises all public keys (A, T) for which A cannot yield hard SIS instances. Then, one can choose arbitrary $x \in \mathbb{Z}^m$ and $\mathbf{msg}$, compute $c = H(x, \mathbf{msg})$, and solve $Az = x - Tc$ for z . Note that these type of weak keys do not exist for the SCHNORR signature scheme, where the generator g is a public parameter and not part of the public key (as is the case for the matrix A). Similarly, if A was a public parameter in Lyubashevsky’s scheme, these weak keys could be prevented.

¹² Depending on the implementation, the verification algorithm might contain a check excluding such invalid values for Z .

Weak Keys of the UOV Signature Scheme. UOV is a multivariate signature scheme that can be seen to have weak keys as defined in [Definition 14](#) using the results from [\[DS24\]](#). They show that for UOV, one can construct two public keys $\mathbf{pk}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{pk}}$, such that for randomly chosen messages $\mathbf{msg}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{msg}}$, the probability of finding a signature $\mathbf{sig}$ such that $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$ and $\text{Verify}(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}}, \mathbf{sig}) = 1$ is non-negligible.

In the following, we provide only the details of UOV necessary to convey the key idea of this result; for a more comprehensive discussion of UOV we refer to [\[BCD⁺24\]](#). On a high-level, a UOV secret key is a matrix $O \in K^{(n-m) \times m}$ (for K a finite field) that defines the so-called oil space as its image. The public key consists of n quadratic polynomials $p_1, \dots, p_n$ which map the oil space to zero. Note that to each p_i , one can associate a matrix

$$P_i = \begin{pmatrix} P_i^{(1)} & P_i^{(2)} \\ 0 & P_i^{(3)} \end{pmatrix} \quad (1)$$

with $P_i^{(1)} \in K^{(n-m) \times (n-m)}$, $P_i^{(2)} \in K^{(n-m) \times m}$, and $P_i^{(3)} \in K^{m \times m}$ such that $p_i(x) = x^\top P_i x$ for any $x \in K^n$, and $P_i^{(1)}$ and $P_i^{(3)}$ are upper triangular matrices. To sign a message $\mathbf{msg}$, a vector $s \in K^n$ such that $s^\top P_i s = H(\mathbf{msg})$ is determined using the oil space. Verification then checks whether this equation holds.

The key idea of finding $\mathbf{pk}$ and $\overline{\mathbf{pk}}$ as described above is then to pick a very large oil space (more precisely, $O \in K^{(n-2m) \times 2m}$) and two different public keys which map this oil space to zero. Note that for the associated matrices (as shown in [Eq. \(1\)](#)), the dimensions of the submatrices will be different, namely $P_i^{(1)} \in K^{(n-2m) \times (n-2m)}$, $P_i^{(2)} \in K^{(n-2m) \times 2m}$, and $P_i^{(3)} \in K^{2m \times 2m}$. Then, given two messages $\mathbf{msg}$, $\overline{\mathbf{msg}}$ and the corresponding targets $H(\mathbf{msg})$, $H(\overline{\mathbf{msg}})$, this choice of public keys allows to find a signature $\mathbf{sig}$ that verifies both targets with non-negligible probability.

In particular, public keys that are obtained like this, are weak by our definition. Note that large oil spaces as described above can never result from honestly generated secret keys as the matrix O is always chosen of dimension $(n-m) \times m$ during **KeyGen**. However, it is possible for an honestly generated public key to map a larger space to zero than the oil space defined by the corresponding secret key. In particular, the public keys we describe above can be the result of **KeyGen** (though, it is unlikely).

So in conclusion, this shows that UOV has weak keys in the image of **KeyGen**. One should be aware that, compared to the analysis we give for SCHNORR and Lyubashevsky’s scheme, this does not provide a complete description of UOV’s weak keys—there might be more inside as well as outside the image of **KeyGen**.

Weak-Key-Checking. Depending on the scheme, efficient checks to exclude the existence of weak keys can be possible.¹³ We formalize this by defining a function

¹³ Note that [\[PS05\]](#) mentions “basic correctness checks” which are implemented by the verifier. Such checks have to be explicitly implemented: Ayer [\[Aye15\]](#) refers to an RSA implementation in Go which does not check for such “implausible” weak keys.

$\text{KeyGen}^*(\cdot)$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$(\text{sig}, z) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$
return (pk, sk)	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, \perp)$	if $z = \perp$
	return sig^*	return $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
		if $z = \text{msg}$
		return 1
		else return 0

Fig. 9: Transform T used to separate our weak key definition from [PS05].

$\text{KeyGen}()$	$\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
$z \leftarrow \text{rand}[q-1]$	$z \leftarrow \text{sk}$	$(e, s) \leftarrow \text{sig}$
$Z \leftarrow g^z$	$k \leftarrow \text{rand}[q-1]$	$Z \leftarrow \text{pk}$
$\text{sk} \leftarrow z$	$r \leftarrow g^k$	$r \leftarrow g^s Z^{-e}$
$\text{pk} \leftarrow Z$	$e \leftarrow \text{H}(\text{msg}, r)$	if $\text{H}(\text{msg}, r) \neq e$
return (pk, sk)	$s \leftarrow k + ze$	return 0
	return $\text{sig} \leftarrow (e, s)$	return 1

Fig. 10: SCHNORR signature scheme. Here, q is a prime and g is a generator of the cyclic group of order q underlying the signature scheme.

WK that takes as input a public key pk and outputs 1 if pk is a weak key and 0 otherwise. For a signature scheme S , we say that S deploys weak-key-checking if the verification algorithm is modified to additionally run WK on the given public key and reject if the output is 0.

From our examples, the SCHNORR signature scheme allows such checking. In the case of SCHNORR signatures, none of the keys in the image of KeyGen are weak, i.e., it suffices to check whether a key is honestly generated to exclude weak keys. The latter can be done by defining $\text{WK}(\text{pk})$ to be 1 if $\text{pk} \in \{0, 1\}$ and 0 otherwise.

The following theorem shows that a PS-3-transformed signature schemes that deploys weak-key-checking, achieves all of the notions from our framework.

Theorem 16. *Let H be a random oracle and S be a signature scheme. If S deploys weak-key-checking, the signature scheme $\text{PS-3}[\mathsf{S}, \text{H}]$ fulfills all 15 binding notions.*

Proof. Denote by S the signature scheme after the PS-3 transform is applied. We show that S achieves $\text{MAL-}[\mathsf{S}, \text{P}]\text{-M}$ and MAL-S-P security, which then implies all other notions by our prior results.

In order to break $\text{MAL-}[\mathsf{S}, \text{P}]\text{-M}$, the adversary has to find two different messages $\text{msg} \neq \overline{\text{msg}}$, a signature sig , and a public key pk such that both $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}), \text{sig}) = 1$ and $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{H}(\text{pk}, \overline{\text{msg}}), \text{sig}) = 1$. In or-

KeyGen()	Sign(sk, msg)	Verify(pk, msg, sig)
$S \leftarrow \{-d, \dots, 0, \dots, d\}^{m \times k}$	$S \leftarrow \mathbf{sk}$	$(z, c) \leftarrow \mathbf{sig}$
$A \leftarrow \mathbb{Z}_q^{n \times m}$	$y \leftarrow D_\sigma^m$	if $\ z\ > \eta\sigma\sqrt{m}$
$T \leftarrow AS$	$c \leftarrow H(Ay, \mathbf{msg})$	return 0
$\mathbf{sk} \leftarrow S$	$z \leftarrow Sc + y$	$c' \leftarrow H(Az - Tc, \mathbf{msg})$
$\mathbf{pk} \leftarrow (A, T)$	With probability p :	return $\llbracket c = c' \rrbracket$
return (pk, sk)	return sig $\leftarrow (z, c)$	
	Otherwise restart	

Fig. 11: Lyubashevsky's signature scheme based on the SIS problem as described in [Lyu12]. Here, $d, n, m, k, q, \sigma \in \mathbb{N}$ and $\eta, M \in \mathbb{R}$ are parameters of the scheme. Further, D_σ^m and $D_{Sc, \sigma}^m$ denote the discrete Gaussian distribution over $\mathbb{Z}^m$ with standard deviation σ , centered in 0 and Sc , respectively. Lastly, the probability p used in **Sign** is computed as $p = \min(D_\sigma^m(z)(MD_{Sc, \sigma}^m(z))^{-1}, 1)$.

der to compute $H(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg})$ and $H(\mathbf{pk}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}})$, the adversary has to fix the public key and messages, which leaves only the signature free to choose. Due to the weak-key-checking, a weak public key will never verify, i.e., we can assume that $\mathbf{pk}$ is not a weak key. In particular, even given only one of the random messages (e.g., $H(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg})$), the probability that an adversary finds $\mathbf{sig}$ such that $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, H(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}), \mathbf{sig}) = 1$ is negligible—which is then also true for the MAL-[S,P]-M advantage.

In the MAL-S-P game, the adversary has to find two different public keys $\mathbf{pk} \neq \overline{\mathbf{pk}}$, two messages $\mathbf{msg}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}}$ (not required to differ) and a signature $\mathbf{sig}$ such that $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, H(\mathbf{pk}, \mathbf{msg}), \mathbf{sig}) = 1$ and $\text{Verify}(\mathbf{pk}, H(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \overline{\mathbf{msg}}), \mathbf{sig}) = 1$. Then, again using weak-key-checking, the same reasoning as above applies. $\square$

Remark 17. Note that the assumptions of the above theorem also yield wNR security. More precisely, for a signature scheme that deploys weak-key-checking, its PS-3-transformed version fulfills wNR. In the wNR the adversary is given a public key $\mathbf{pk}$ and a signature $\mathbf{sig}$ of a randomly chosen message $\mathbf{msg}$, which the adversary does *not* receive. The adversary has to find a different public key $\overline{\mathbf{pk}}$ and a (potentially different) signature $\overline{\mathbf{sig}}$ such that $\text{Verify}(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, H(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \mathbf{msg}), \overline{\mathbf{sig}}) = 1$. If the adversary chooses $\overline{\mathbf{pk}}$ to be a weak key, verify will never succeed due to the weak-key checking—hence, we can assume that $\overline{\mathbf{pk}}$ is not a weak key. Then, the probability that the adversary finds $\overline{\mathbf{sig}}$ with $\text{Verify}(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, H(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \mathbf{msg}), \overline{\mathbf{sig}}) = 1$ for $H(\overline{\mathbf{pk}}, \mathbf{msg})$ random (and unknown), is negligible.

Out of our 15 binding notions, two restrict the adversary to honestly generated public keys: LEAK-[S,P]-M and HON-[S,P]-M. The following corollary states that the PS-3 transform satisfies these notions if the underlying signature scheme is unforgeable. The reason is that unforgeability effectively rules out that the target public key is a weak key.

Corollary 18. *Applying the PS-3 transform to an EUF-CMA secure signature scheme, yields a scheme that fulfills LEAK-[S,P]-M and HON-[S,P]-M.*

Proof. Firstly note that a signature scheme that fulfills EUF-CMA security can have only negligible many weak keys. Since the key pairs in the notions LEAK-[S,P]-M and HON-[S,P]-M are honestly generated, the probability of the adversary playing against a weak key is negligible. Then the same reasoning as in the proof of Theorem 16 yields security. $\square$

4.3 Analysis of Signature-increasing Transformations

Analysis of the PS-1 and PS-2 Transforms. Since the PS-1 and the PS-2 transform append the hash of the message $H(\text{msg})$ or the hash of the public key $H(\text{pk})$, respectively, to the signature, they achieve all notions for which the adversary has to choose two different messages or public keys, respectively. In particular, this does not depend on the adversarial model. The corresponding theorems are written below.

Theorem 19. *Let H be a random oracle and S be a signature scheme. The signature scheme PS-1[S, H] fulfills AM-S-M, AM-[S,P]-M, and AM-S-[M,P] for $\text{AM} \in \{\text{HON}, \text{LEAK}, \text{MAL}\}$.*

Theorem 20. *Let H be a random oracle and S be a signature scheme. The signature scheme PS-2[S, H] fulfills AM-S-P, AM-S-[M,P], and AM-[S,M]-P for $\text{AM} \in \{\text{HON}, \text{LEAK}, \text{MAL}\}$.*

Analysis of the BUFF-lite and BUFF Transform. The following theorem shows that the BUFF-lite transform achieves all the new notion in our framework. From this, we can follow that the BUFF transform achieves all these notions as well. Thus, the only difference between the transformations still lies in whether NR is achieved—as was the case for the original BUFF notions.

Theorem 21. *Let H be a random oracle and S be a signature scheme. The signature scheme BUFF-lite[S, H] fulfills all 15 binding notions.*

Proof. By [CDF⁺21, Theorem 5.5], a BUFF-lite transformed signature scheme fulfills M-S-UEO and MBS, i.e., MAL-S-P and MAL-[S,P]-M security in our notation. Using Theorem 5, MAL-S-P security implies that MAL-S-[M,P] and MAL-[S,M]-P hold. Furthermore, Theorem 6 shows that MAL-S-[M,P] together with MAL-[S,P]-M yields MAL-S-M security. Thus, all five of the MAL notions hold after the BUFF-lite transform is applied and hence also all of the corresponding weaker HON and LEAK notions are fulfilled. $\square$

Remark 22. Note that the above proof boils down to the fact that MAL-S-P and MAL-[S,P]-M imply all other notions.

Corollary 23. *Application of the BUFF transformation produces a signature scheme that fulfills all 15 binding notions.*

4.4 Updated Overview of Transformations

After the analysis conducted in the prior two sections, we can now give an updated overview of the properties achieved by the different transformations. Starting with the PS-3 transform, we gave a new formalization of weak keys. If these keys do not exist for a signature scheme or can be excluded by additional check during verification, we showed that the PS-3 transform suffices to achieve *all* notions from our framework. An overview of the existing and new results regarding the PS-3 transform is given in Fig. 12.

Then, for the signature-increasing transforms, i.e., PS-1, PS-2, BUFF-lite, and BUFF, we also gave an updated analysis: Next to the particular BUFF notions that were already known to be achieved by the transforms, a number of new notions from our framework can be achieved. More precisely, the PS-1 transform achieves all notions AM-B-T for which $M \in T$, i.e., a total of nine notions. Analogously, the PS-2 transform yields all notions AM-B-T for which $P \in T$, i.e., again a total of nine notions. This might seem surprising at first glance, as for the original BUFF notions PS-2 achieved more notions (S-CEO, S-DEO, M-S-UEO) than PS-1 (S-DEO, MBS). However, in view of the completed picture for the notions, we see that PS-2 also achieves the previously unknown notion MAL-S-M. Thus, it makes sense that the two transforms symmetrically provide coverage of all notions: PS-1 covers all notions for which the message is bound (as $H(\text{msg})$ is appended to the signature) and PS-2 achieves all notions for which the public key is bound (as $H(\text{pk})$ is appended to the signature). In particular, the transforms cross over in the three notions where both message *and* public key are bound. Lastly, we showed that the BUFF-lite and the BUFF transform not only yield all of the BUFF notions but also all notions from our new framework. In particular, this implies that no new transforms need to be developed in order to obtain the complete framework. An illustration of the new results regarding the PS-1, PS-2, BUFF-lite, and BUFF transform is given in Fig. 13.

Lastly, when comparing the PS-3 and the BUFF(-lite) transform, we observe that both can be considered for achieving all notions: While the BUFF(-lite) transform can be applied to *any* signature scheme, this comes at the cost of signature expansion; for the PS-3 transform this drawback is not present, however, a scheme-specific analysis of weak keys—according to our new definition—is necessary.

5 Non-Resignability in our new Framework

Until now, we showed that our framework encompasses the existing BUFF notions of exclusive ownership (in its various forms) and message-bound signatures. The BUFF notion we have yet to discuss is non-resignability. We show how a slight adaption of the notions allows to also encompass—at least to some extent—the notion of non-resignability with our framework.

While the notion HON-M-P can always be broken by an adversary (simply by re-signing the message with a different key-pair), a slight adaption where the

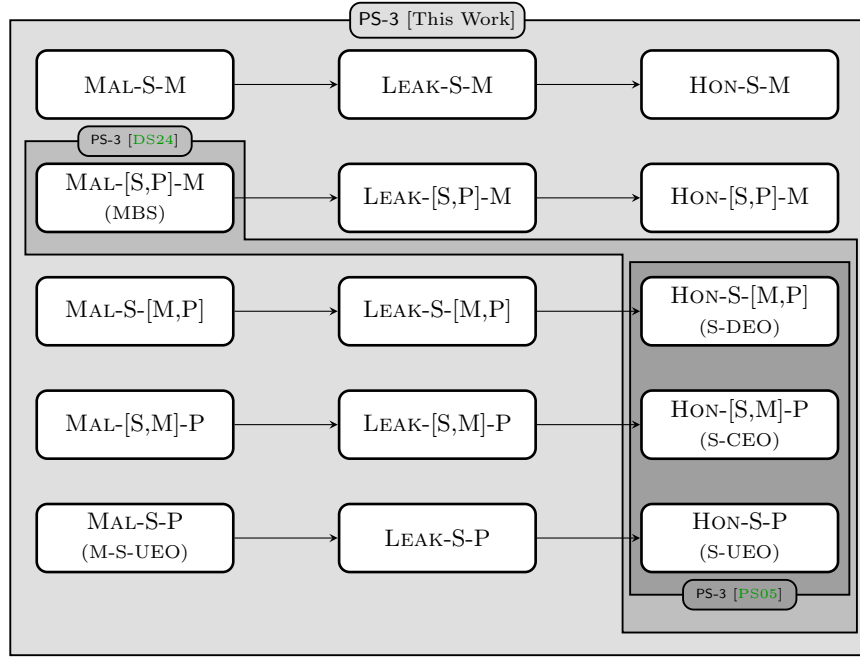


Fig. 12: Existing and new results regarding the PS-3 transform. Note that the result from [DS24] assumes that the *underlying* signature scheme achieves $\text{MAL-}[S,P]\text{-M}$ security.

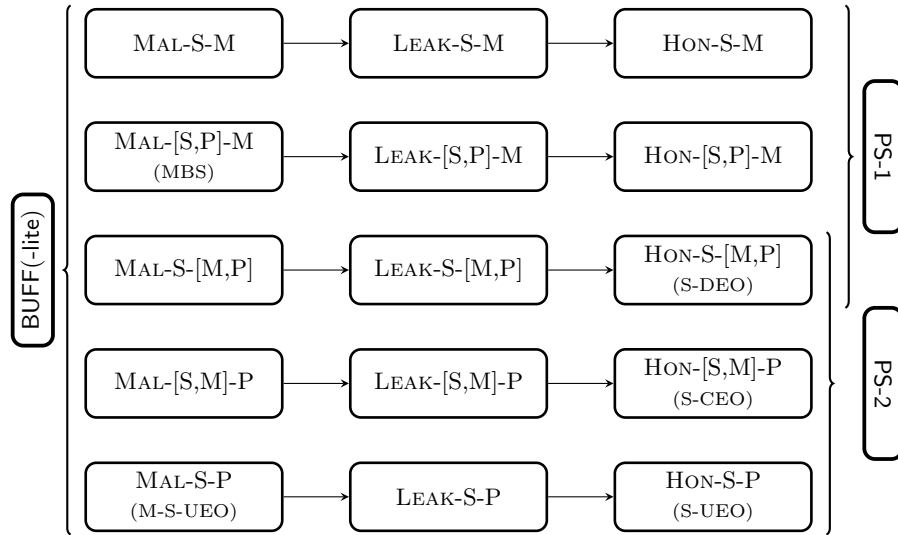


Fig. 13: Our results regarding the transforms PS-1, PS-2, BUFF-lite, and BUFF. The brackets denote that PS-1 and PS-2 achieve the upper 9 and lower 9 notions, respectively, while BUFF(-lite) achieve all 15 notions.

message is hidden from the adversary ($\text{HON-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$ ¹⁴) yields the existing BUFF notion non-resignability (NR)—we display the new notions with hidden components in Fig. 15. Here, the adversary is given a public key and signature that verify a message unknown to the adversary, who then has to find a different public key and a (possibly different) signature that also verify the unknown message. Note, however, that the NR notion provides the adversary some auxiliary information (with certain restrictions) about the message. The variant we consider here corresponds to the weak non-resignability (wNR) notion as put forth in [ADM⁺24], where no auxiliary information exists. Another difference is that our notion provides the adversary with a sign oracle, while the wNR notion does not. It is easy to see the oracle does not help the adversary: queries on different messages cannot reveal anything about the randomly chosen target message and the secret key—due to being generated before choosing the target message—cannot encode any information that are leaked through signing queries. We opt to keep the oracle for the sake of consistency with the binding framework.

The notion $\text{HON-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$ can be decomposed into the notions $\text{HON-}[\text{S},\widehat{\text{M}}]\text{-P}$ and $\text{HON-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[\text{S},\text{P}]$, which specify whether the signature differs. More precisely, analog to Theorem 5 and Theorem 6, $\text{HON-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$ holds if and only if $\text{HON-}[\text{S},\widehat{\text{M}}]\text{-P}$ and $\text{HON-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[\text{S},\text{P}]$ are fulfilled. While NR is originally formulated in the honest setting, we can now also consider the leaked and malicious variants.

Using the idea of hidden components, we next want to check whether there are other notions that transfer to this setting in a meaningful way. Firstly, we do not consider notions with hidden signatures or public keys, as these will always be accessible for the adversary. Considering public keys to be hidden seems unreasonable as in this case, signer and verifier essentially share keys that are concealed from the adversary—in which case, they could simply use a MAC. Likewise, while the message might remain (partially) hidden in a specific application, e.g., the dynamically recreatable key protocol [KBJ⁺14], the signature has to be communicated visible to the adversary.¹⁵ Secondly, we exclude the cases where the message is hidden in the target, i.e., notions of the form $\text{AM-B-}\widehat{\text{M}}$ —here the adversary would have to find a message different from a message that is unknown to him. Excluding the NR notions from above, this leaves only the notions $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-S} \Leftrightarrow \text{AM-}[\widehat{\text{M}},\text{P}]\text{-S} \wedge \text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[\text{S},\text{P}]$ (keeping the overline-notation to indicate the concealed component). For these notions, a signature to an unknown message is given and the adversary has to find another signature for this message—either using the same public key ($\text{AM-}[\widehat{\text{M}},\text{P}]\text{-S}$) or a different one ($\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[\text{S},\text{P}]$). The first notion, $\text{AM-}[\widehat{\text{M}},\text{P}]\text{-S}$, is a stricter version of strong unforgeability in the case $\text{AM} = \text{HON}$ as the adversary has to forge another signature for an *unknown* message. In particular, the notion $\text{HON-}[\widehat{\text{M}},\text{P}]\text{-S}$ is always fulfilled for signature schemes that are strongly unforgeable. The second notion, $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[\text{S},\text{P}]$, is the restricted form of weak non-resignability we identified above.

¹⁴ The overline is to indicate the component that is concealed from the adversary.

¹⁵ If the signature could be communicated securely out-of-band, sender and receiver could also communicate the messages this way.

In total, expanding our framework by the $\neg$ operation, yields the two new generalized notions $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$ and $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-S}$, and the three new restricted notions $\text{AM-}[S, \widehat{\text{M}}]\text{-P}$, $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[S, \text{P}]$, and $\text{AM-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S}$. The first generalized notion, $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$ encompasses the existing notion of weak non-resignability and allows the distinction into $\text{AM-}[S, \widehat{\text{M}}]\text{-P}$ and $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[S, \text{P}]$. The second general notion, $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-S}$ decomposes into $\text{AM-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S}$ and $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[S, \text{P}]$, hence intersecting the weak non-resignability class in $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[S, \text{P}]$.

The **BUFF** transform achieves non-resignability and thus especially the weaker form wNR, which corresponds to $\text{HON-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$ in our framework. However, a **BUFF**-transformed scheme is also easily seen to achieve wNR in the MAL setting, i.e., $\text{MAL-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$: The **BUFF** transform hashes the message and public key, signs the result, and appends it to the signature. A $\text{MAL-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$ adversary $\mathcal{A}$ can choose (pk, sk) , obtains a signature sig for an unknown message under the chosen key pair, and has to find another public key $\overline{\text{pk}}$ and a (potentially different) signature $\overline{\text{sig}}$ which verify the unknown message. While the adversary can simply choose a second key pair $(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{sk}})$ to use for signing, the fact that $\overline{\text{pk}} \neq \text{pk}$ needs to hold, means $\mathcal{A}$ has to compute the hash value $\text{H}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \text{msg})$ for an unknown message, with only the knowledge of $\text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$. This is not possible for a secure hash function. Thus, a **BUFF** transformed signature scheme achieves $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-P}$, $\text{AM-}[S, \widehat{\text{M}}]\text{-P}$, and $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[S, \text{P}]$ for all attack models.

Regarding the remaining notions, we note that

$$\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-S} \Leftrightarrow (\text{AM-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S} \wedge \text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[S, \text{P}])$$

and that we have already shown $\text{AM-}\widehat{\text{M}}\text{-}[S, \text{P}]$ to be achievable in all attack models. Thus it remains to analyze $\text{AM-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S}$ for $\text{AM} \in \{\text{HON}, \text{LEAK}, \text{MAL}\}$: As described above, $\text{HON-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S}$ is fulfilled by a strongly unforgeable signature scheme. Regarding $\text{MAL-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S}$, we observe that a **BUFF**-transformed *probabilistic* signature scheme does not achieve the notion. The reason is that the adversary can use the hash value $\text{H}(\text{pk}, \text{msg})$ that is part of the given signature and re-sign it with sk , which will (very likely) result in a signature different from the given one. We leave the question whether $\text{LEAK-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S}$ and $\text{MAL-}[\widehat{\text{M}}, \text{P}]\text{-S}$ are achievable for future work.¹⁶

¹⁶ Note that the **LEAK** setting is similar to the strong non-resignability notion given in [DFH⁺24] which provides the adversary not just with the public key but also the secret key. However, our notion still considers a uniformly chosen message with no auxiliary information whereas the notion in [DFH⁺24] does.

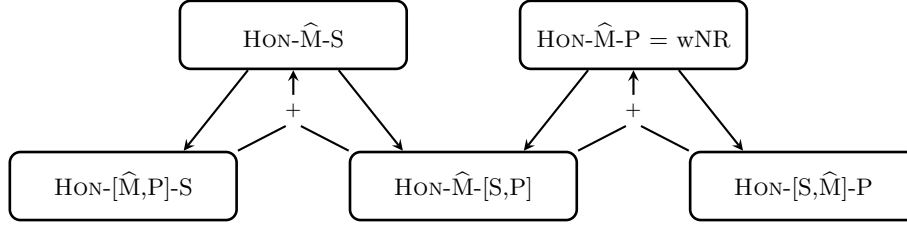


Fig. 14: Implications between the modified notions and their relation to non-resignability.

Game HON-M-P	Game LEAK-M-P	Game MAL-M-P
$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $msg \leftarrow \mathcal{M}$ $sig \leftarrow \text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $(\overline{sig}, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk, sig)$ if $pk \neq \overline{pk}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \rrbracket$	$(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $msg \leftarrow \mathcal{M}$ $sig \leftarrow \text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $(\overline{sig}, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(pk, sk, sig)$ if $pk \neq \overline{pk}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \rrbracket$	$(pk, sk) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}_0()$ $msg \leftarrow \mathcal{M}$ $sig \leftarrow \text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $(\overline{sig}, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}_1(sig)$ if $pk \neq \overline{pk}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \rrbracket$
Game HON-M-S	Game LEAK-M-S	Game MAL-M-S
$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $msg \leftarrow \mathcal{M}$ $sig \leftarrow \text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $(\overline{sig}, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk, sig)$ if $sig \neq \overline{sig}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \rrbracket$	$(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $msg \leftarrow \mathcal{M}$ $sig \leftarrow \text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $(\overline{sig}, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(pk, sk, sig)$ if $sig \neq \overline{sig}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \rrbracket$	$(pk, sk) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}_0()$ $msg \leftarrow \mathcal{M}$ $sig \leftarrow \text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $(\overline{sig}, \overline{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}_1(sig)$ if $sig \neq \overline{sig}$ return 0 $v \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{pk}, msg, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v = 1 \rrbracket$

Fig. 15: The generic notions AM-M-P and AM-M-S . Note that the restricted notions AM-[S,M]-P , AM-M-[S,P] , and AM-[M,P]-S can easily be derived from the generic ones by adding the additional checks as prescribed by the restrictions. We omit the sign oracle, which works in the obvious way and keeps track of the queries/responses via $\mathcal{Q}$.

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A Unforgeability in our new Framework

In [Section 3](#), we excluded several notions, arguing that they are unachievable. One of these notions was HON-P-M. We showed that one can just query two different messages to the signing oracle and thus break the notion. In this section, we consider an adapted variant and discuss its connection to unforgeability. This variant, denoted by HON-P-M*, agrees with HON-P-M except for the following: While one of the message signature pairs outputted by the adversary has to stem from a **Sign** query, the second message is *not* allowed to have been queried. Due to this change, the notion HON-P-M* (shown in [Fig. 16](#)) corresponds to EUF-CMA. More generally, in the following an asterisk appended to message/signature denotes that the second message/signature outputted by the adversary is *not* allowed to have been query/response to the **Sign** oracle.

Analogously to [Theorem 5](#) and [Theorem 6](#), we can also break down HON-P-M* in the two notions HON-[S,P]-M* and HON-P-[S*,M*]. The latter notion is also part of a second relation: HON-P-[S*,M*] and HON-[M,P]-S* are equivalent to HON-P-S*. All of the new notions are described in detail in [Fig. 16](#) and [Fig. 17](#).

Note that—additionally to HON-P-M* agreeing with EUF-CMA—strong unforgeability arises as the combination of HON-P-M* and HON-[M,P]-S*: the former is EUF-CMA as just discussed, while the latter asks to find two signatures for the same message, i.e., exactly the difference between EUF-CMA and SUF-CMA. Further, observe that all of the new notions in [Fig. 16](#) and [Fig. 17](#) did not exist in our framework previously (due to not being achievable)—with the exception of HON-[S,P]-M. Due to the fact that HON-[S,P]-M* is more restricted, HON-[S,P]-M implies HON-[S,P]-M*. However, the converse is not true, as an adversary against HON-[S,P]-M can output a message that was queried to the **Sign** oracle before, while an adversary against HON-[S,P]-M* cannot. For example, consider a HON-[S,P]-M adversary that makes the following **Sign** queries:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg}_1) &= \text{sig}_1 \\ \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg}_2) &= \text{sig}_2\end{aligned}$$

If the adversary then notices that msg_1 also verifies for sig_2 , i.e.,

$$\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}_1, \text{sig}_2) = \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}_2, \text{sig}_2) = 1,$$

the adversary can break HON-[S,P]-M by outputting $(\text{sig}_2, \text{msg}_1, \text{msg}_2)$. However, the adversary cannot break HON-[S,P]-M* as both messages have been queried to **Sign**. An overview of all relations is given in [Fig. 18](#).

B Postponed Proofs

B.1 Proof of [Theorem 10](#)

Proof. Let $\mathbf{S}$ be a signature scheme that is both AM-S-[M,P] and AM-[S,M]-P. Let further $\mathbf{S}^*$ be the signature scheme displayed in [Fig. 19](#).

Game HON-P-M*	Game HON-P-S*
$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$
$(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{\$KeyGen}()$	$(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{\$KeyGen}()$
$(sig, \overline{sig}, msg, \overline{msg}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$	$(sig, \overline{sig}, msg, \overline{msg}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$
if $(msg, sig) \notin \mathcal{Q}$	if $(msg, sig) \notin \mathcal{Q}$
return 0	return 0
if $(\overline{msg}, \cdot) \in \mathcal{Q}$	if $(\cdot, \overline{sig}) \in \mathcal{Q}$
return 0	return 0
if $msg = \overline{msg}$	if $sig = \overline{sig}$
return 0	return 0
$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, msg, sig)$	$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, msg, sig)$
$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, \overline{msg}, \overline{sig})$	$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, \overline{msg}, \overline{sig})$
return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$

Fig. 16: Modified (generalized) notions related to unforgeability.

To break AM-[S,M]-P, consider an adversary that receives an honestly generated public key $pk^* = (pk, 1)$, queries msg^* to its signing oracle, and receives a signature $sig^* = (sig, 0)$. By outputting $\overline{pk}^* = (pk, 0)$, $\text{Verify}^*(pk^*, msg^*, sig^*)$ will output 1 via the normal verification check while $\text{Verify}^*(\overline{pk}^*, msg^*, sig^*)$ will output 1 via the special verification check; therefore this adversary breaks AM-[S,M]-P for $AM \in \{MAL, LEAK, HON\}$.

Regarding AM-S-[M,P], note that any public key with a trailing 0 can only verify exactly one message, that is, msg^* . Any AM-[S,M]-P adversary therefore needs to output a public key having a trailing 1 in which case the signature scheme is equal to the underlying signature scheme, thus inheriting its AM-[S,M]-P security for $AM \in \{MAL, LEAK, HON\}$. $\square$

B.2 Proof of Theorem 11

Proof. Let S be a signature scheme that is both AM-[S,M]-P and AM-S-[M,P]. Let further S^* be the signature scheme displayed in Fig. 20.

To break AM-S-[M,P], consider an adversary that receives an honestly generated public key $pk^* = (pk, 1)$, queries msg^* to its signing oracle, and receives a signature $sig^* = (sig, 0)$. By outputting $(sig^* = (sig, 0), msg^*, msg^{**}, \overline{pk}^* = (pk, 0))$, $\text{Verify}^*(pk^*, msg^*, sig^*)$ will output 1 via the special verification check (third if condition) while $\text{Verify}^*(\overline{pk}^*, msg^{**}, sig^*)$ will output 1 via the special verification check (first if condition); thus the adversary breaks AM-S-[M,P] for $AM \in \{MAL, LEAK, HON\}$.

Regarding AM-[S,M]-P, observe that signatures with a trailing 0 can verify exactly two messages (msg^* and msg^{**}) but only under distinct public keys

(verification of msg^* and msg^{**} requires a public key with a trailing 1 and 0, respectively). Thus, any successful AM-[S,M]-P needs to output a signature with a trailing 1. However, in this case, the transformed signature scheme is equivalent to the underlying signature scheme and inherits its AM-[S,M]-P security. $\square$

B.3 Proof of Theorem 12

Note that the separation example for this proof is a signature scheme that is not unforgeable. This is to be expected as our separations apply to all attack models and the notion HON-[S,P]-M, i.e. AM-[S,P]-M in the HON setting, is related to unforgeability. We elaborate further on this connection in [Appendix A](#).

Proof. Let $\mathbf{S}$ be a signature scheme that is both AM-[S,P]-M and AM-S-[M,P]. Let further $\mathbf{S}^*$ be the signature scheme displayed in [Fig. 21](#).

Firstly, we show that the signature scheme $\mathbf{S}^*$ is not AM-[S,P]-M. An adversary $\mathcal{A}$, receiving a public key pk , can simply ask for any signature and receive $\text{sig}^* = (\text{sig}, \text{pk})$. By construction, sig^* verifies under pk for *any* message, i.e., $\mathcal{A}$ can simply output $(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk})$.

To show that $\mathbf{S}^*$ is AM-S-[M,P], observe that signatures (sig, z) for $z \neq \perp$ verify *only* under public key z —in which case they verify any message though. This makes it impossible to break AM-S-[M,P] via this special verification step, as $\mathcal{A}$ needs to provide a signature and two *distinct* public keys that verify this signature. For signatures (sig, z) with $z = \perp$, $\mathbf{S}^*$ is equal to the underlying signature scheme and thus maintains its AM-S-[M,P] security. $\square$

B.4 Proof of Theorem 13

Proof. The result follows from [\[ADM⁺24\]](#), which shows that UOV [\[BCD⁺24\]](#) achieves MBS, i.e., it is AM-[S,P]-M for $\text{AM} \in \{\text{MAL}, \text{LEAK}, \text{HON}\}$, but not S-DEO, i.e., it is not AM-S-[M,P] for $\text{AM} \in \{\text{MAL}, \text{LEAK}, \text{HON}\}$. $\square$

C Explicit Security Notions

In this section, we give the individual security games for all 15 notions: AM-S-M in [Fig. 22](#), AM-[S,P]-M in [Fig. 23](#), AM-S-[M,P] in [Fig. 24](#), AM-[S,M]-P in [Fig. 25](#), and lastly AM-S-P in [Fig. 26](#).

Game HON-[S,P]-M*	Game HON-P-[S*,M*]
$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{\$KeyGen}()$ $(sig, msg, \overline{msg}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$ if $(msg, sig) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $(\overline{msg}, \cdot) \in \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $msg = \overline{msg}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, msg, sig)$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, \overline{msg}, sig)$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{\$KeyGen}()$ $(sig, \overline{sig}, msg, \overline{msg}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$ if $(msg, sig) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $(\overline{msg}, \cdot) \in \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $(\cdot, \overline{sig}) \in \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $msg = \overline{msg}$ return 0 if $sig = \overline{sig}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, msg, sig)$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, \overline{msg}, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$
Game HON-[M,P]-S*	
$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(pk, sk) \leftarrow \text{\$KeyGen}()$ $(sig, \overline{sig}, msg) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(sk, \cdot)}(pk)$ if $(msg, sig) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $(\cdot, \overline{sig}) \in \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $sig = \overline{sig}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, msg, sig)$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(pk, \overline{msg}, \overline{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	Oracle $\text{Sign}(sk, msg)$ $sig \leftarrow \text{\$Sign}(sk, msg)$ $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \mathcal{Q} \cup \{(msg, sig)\}$ return sig

Fig. 17: Modified (restricted) notions related to unforgeability.

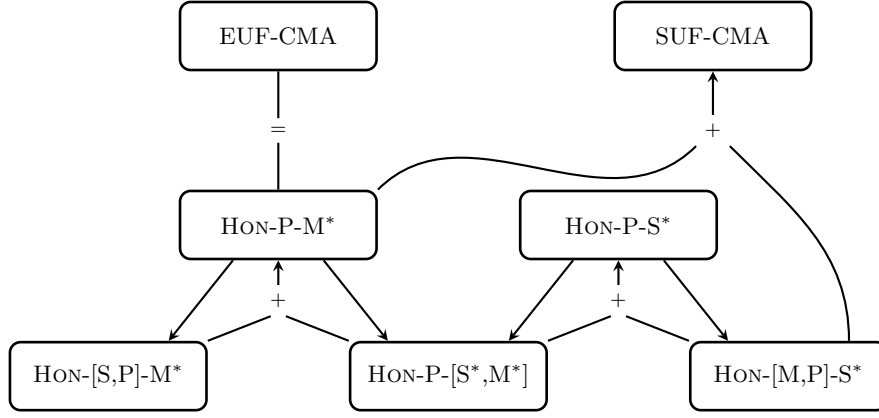


Fig. 18: Implications between the modified notions and their relation to unforgeability.

$\text{KeyGen}^*(\cdot)$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}^*, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$(\text{pk}, b) \leftarrow \text{pk}^*$
$\text{pk}^* \leftarrow (\text{pk}, 1)$	if $\text{msg} = \text{msg}_*$	$(\text{sig}, d) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$
return (pk^*, sk)	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, 0)$	if $b = 0$ // Dishonest key
	else	return $\llbracket d = 0 \wedge \text{msg} = \text{msg}_* \rrbracket$
	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, 1)$	if $b = 1$
	return sig^*	return $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$

Fig. 19: Separation example for $\text{AM-S}[\text{M}, \text{P}] \not\Rightarrow \text{AM}[\text{S}, \text{M}]\text{-P}$ (Theorem 10).

$\text{KeyGen}^*(\cdot)$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}^*, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$(\text{pk}, b) \leftarrow \text{pk}^*$
$\text{pk}^* \leftarrow (\text{pk}, 1)$	$(\text{sig}, d) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$
return (pk^*, sk)	if $b = 0 \wedge d = 0$
	return $\llbracket \text{msg} = \text{msg}_{**} \rrbracket$
$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	if $b = 0 \wedge d = 1$
$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	return 0
if $\text{msg} = \text{msg}_*$	if $b = 1 \wedge d = 0$
$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, 0)$	return $\llbracket \text{msg} = \text{msg}_* \wedge \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}) \rrbracket$
else	if $b = 1 \wedge d = 1$
$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, 1)$	return $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
return sig^*	

Fig. 20: Separation example for $\text{AM}[\text{S}, \text{M}]\text{-P} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-S}[\text{M}, \text{P}]$ (Theorem 11).

$\text{KeyGen}^*(\cdot)$	$\text{Sign}^*(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$\text{Verify}^*(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig}^*)$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$	$(\text{sig}, z) \leftarrow \text{sig}^*$
return (pk, sk)	$\text{sig}^* \leftarrow (\text{sig}, \text{pk})$	if $z \neq \perp$
	return sig^*	return $\llbracket z = \text{pk} \rrbracket$
		if $z = \perp$
		return $\text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$

Fig. 21: Separation example for $\text{AM-S-[M,P]} \not\Rightarrow \text{AM-[S,P]-M}$ (Theorem 12).

Game MAL-S-M	Game HON-S-M
$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$
if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}}$	$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$
return 0	$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \cdot)}(\text{pk})$
$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	if $(\text{msg}, \text{sig}) \notin \mathcal{Q}$
$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$	return 0
return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}}$
	return 0
	$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
	$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$
	return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$
Game LEAK-S-M	Oracle $\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\text{pk}, \text{sk})$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \mathcal{Q} \cup \{(\text{msg}, \text{sig})\}$
if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}}$	return sig
return 0	
$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	
$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$	
return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	

Fig. 22: The notions MAL-S-M, LEAK-S-M, and HON-S-M.

Game MAL-[S,P]-M $(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$ if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	Game HON-[S,P]-M $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \cdot)}(\text{pk})$ if $(\text{msg}, \text{sig}) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$
Game LEAK-[S,P]-M $(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\text{pk}, \text{sk})$ if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	Oracle $\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$ $\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$ $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \mathcal{Q} \cup \{(\text{msg}, \text{sig})\}$ return sig

Fig. 23: The notions MAL-[S,P]-M, LEAK-[S,P]-M, and HON-[S,P]-M.

Game MAL-S-[M,P] $(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$ if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}} \vee \text{pk} = \overline{\text{pk}}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	Game HON-S-[M,P] $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$ $(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \cdot)}(\text{pk})$ if $(\text{msg}, \text{sig}) \notin \mathcal{Q}$ return 0 if $\overline{\text{msg}} = \text{msg} \vee \overline{\text{pk}} = \text{pk}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$
Game LEAK-S-[M,P] $(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$ $(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\text{pk}, \text{sk})$ if $\text{msg} = \overline{\text{msg}} \vee \text{pk} = \overline{\text{pk}}$ return 0 $v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$ $v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$ return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	Oracle $\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$ $\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$ $\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \mathcal{Q} \cup \{(\text{msg}, \text{sig})\}$ return sig

Fig. 24: The notions MAL-S-[M,P], LEAK-S-[M,P], and HON-S-[M,P].

Game MAL-[S,M]-P	Game HON-[S,M]-P
$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \text{pk}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$
if $\text{pk} = \overline{\text{pk}}$	$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$
return 0	$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \cdot)}(\text{pk})$
$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	if $(\text{msg}, \text{sig}) \notin \mathcal{Q}$
$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	return 0
return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	if $\overline{\text{pk}} = \text{pk}$
	return 0
Game LEAK-[S,M]-P	$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$v_2 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\text{pk}, \text{sk})$	return $\llbracket v_1 = 1 \wedge v_2 = 1 \rrbracket$
if $\text{pk} = \overline{\text{pk}}$	
return 0	Oracle $\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \mathcal{Q} \cup \{(\text{msg}, \text{sig})\}$
return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	return sig

Fig. 25: The notions MAL-[S,M]-P, LEAK-[S,M]-P, and HON-[S,M]-P.

Game MAL-S-P	Game HON-S-P
$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{pk}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}()$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \emptyset$
if $\text{pk} \neq \overline{\text{pk}}$	$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$
return 0	$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}^{\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \cdot)}(\text{pk})$
$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	if $(\text{msg}, \text{sig}) \notin \mathcal{Q}$
$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$	return 0
return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	if $\text{pk} \neq \overline{\text{pk}}$
	return 0
Game LEAK-S-P	$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$
$(\text{pk}, \text{sk}) \leftarrow \text{KeyGen}()$	$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$
$(\text{sig}, \text{msg}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \overline{\text{pk}}) \leftarrow \mathcal{A}(\text{pk}, \text{sk})$	return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$
if $\text{pk} \neq \overline{\text{pk}}$	
return 0	Oracle $\text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$v_0 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\text{pk}, \text{msg}, \text{sig})$	$\text{sig} \leftarrow \text{Sign}(\text{sk}, \text{msg})$
$v_1 \leftarrow \text{Verify}(\overline{\text{pk}}, \overline{\text{msg}}, \text{sig})$	$\mathcal{Q} \leftarrow \mathcal{Q} \cup \{(\text{msg}, \text{sig})\}$
return $\llbracket v_0 = 1 \wedge v_1 = 1 \rrbracket$	return sig

Fig. 26: The notions MAL-S-P, LEAK-S-P, and HON-S-P.